

02

motion-picture museum

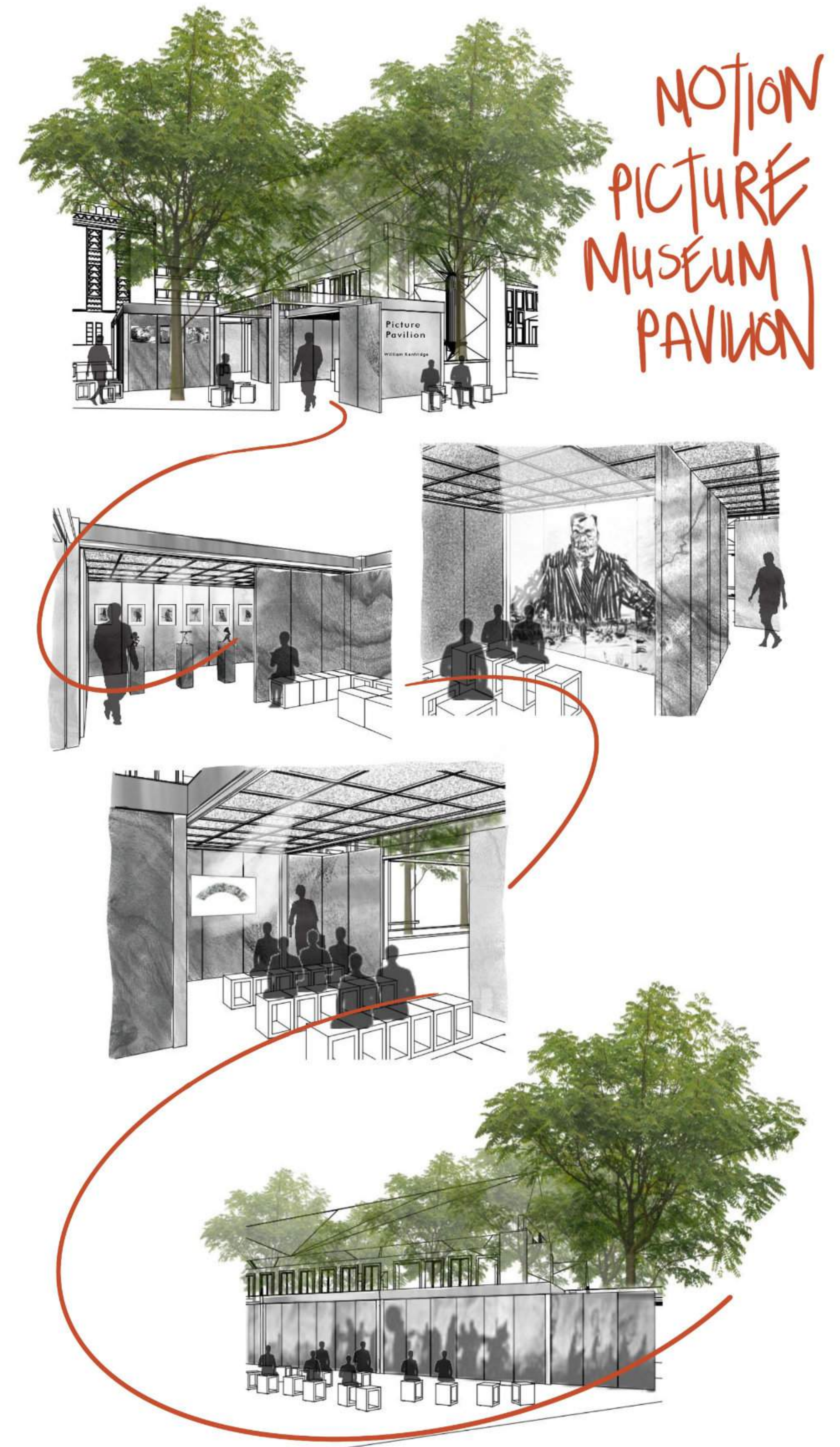
pop-up museum

Project Timeline: Q2 Honours Project [2023]

Location: University of Pretoria, South Africa

Approach: Temporary installation

Software: Revit, Affinity Designer & Procreate



Project Overview

the brief

To design a *public and adaptable museum pavilion* along the University of Pretoria's arts axis, serving as an *interface* between the *UP Museums' collections, programmes, students* and the broader community.

the problem identified

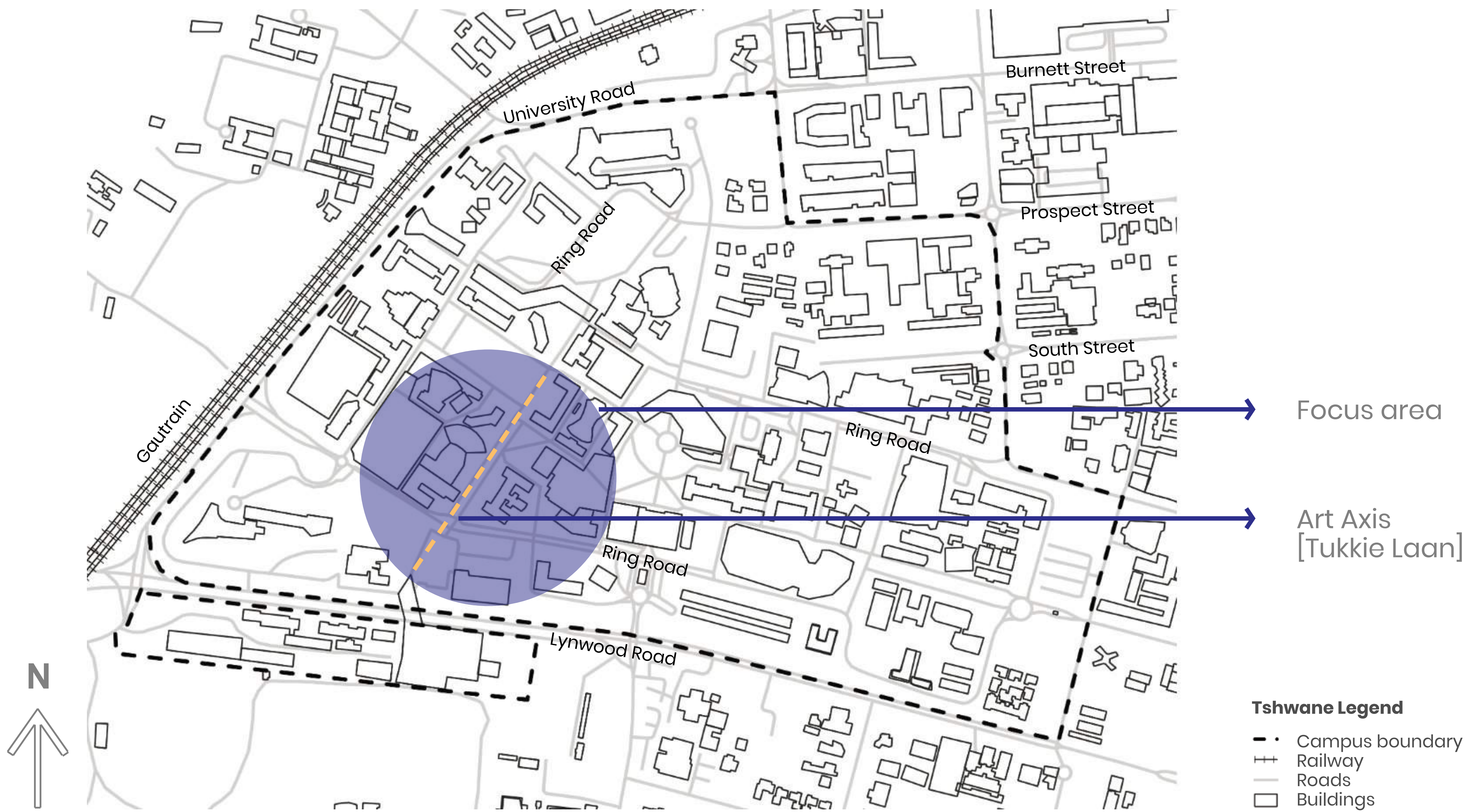
While there is a rich concentration of cultural assets (like museums, archives, and galleries) at the UP Hatfield campus, there is a *need for more visible, accessible, and meaningful architectural interventions that activate these resources* in the public realm and connect them to wider audiences.

the solution

There is an opportunity for exploration that introduces the idea of *motion picture into the role of museums* and changing the narrative that they can be used as a medium to enrich the museum experience in this digital era that we find ourselves in – especially with the rise of Gen Z on our doorstep.

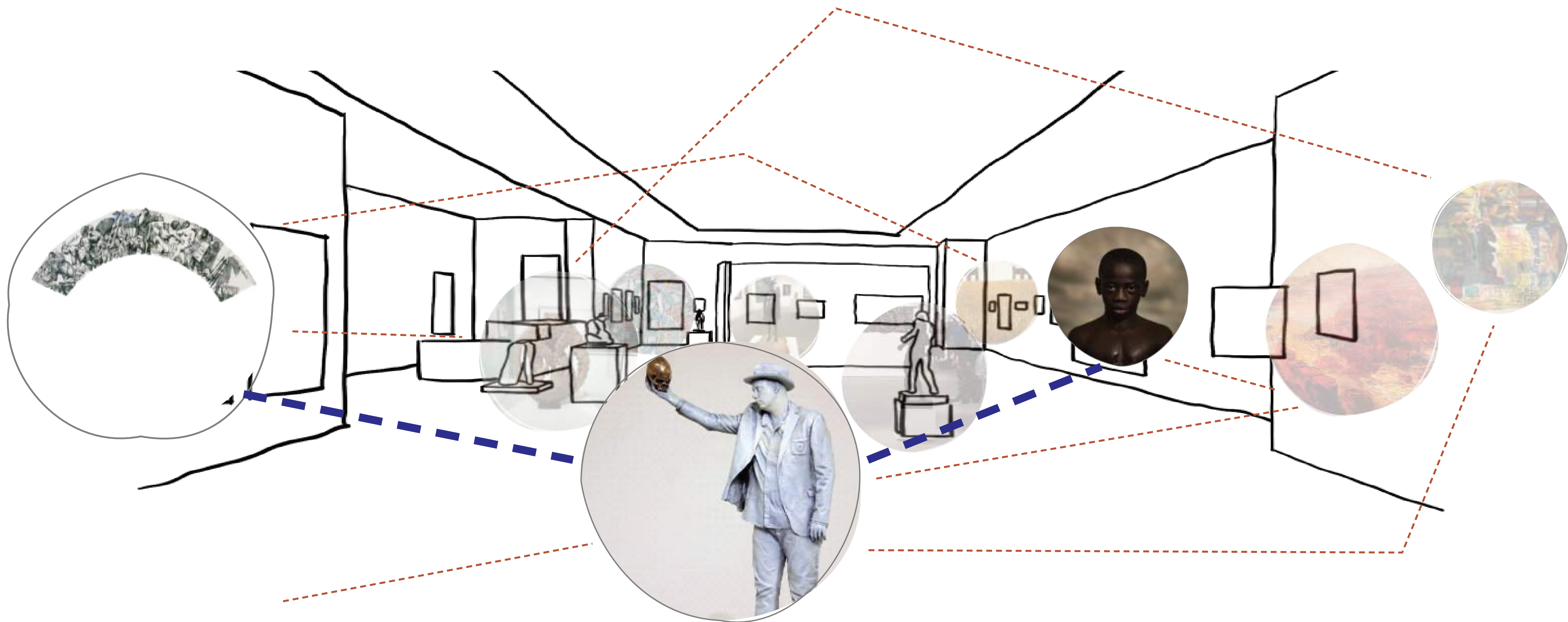
the setting

University of Pretoria, Hatfield Campus, Arts Axis, [Pretoria, South Africa].

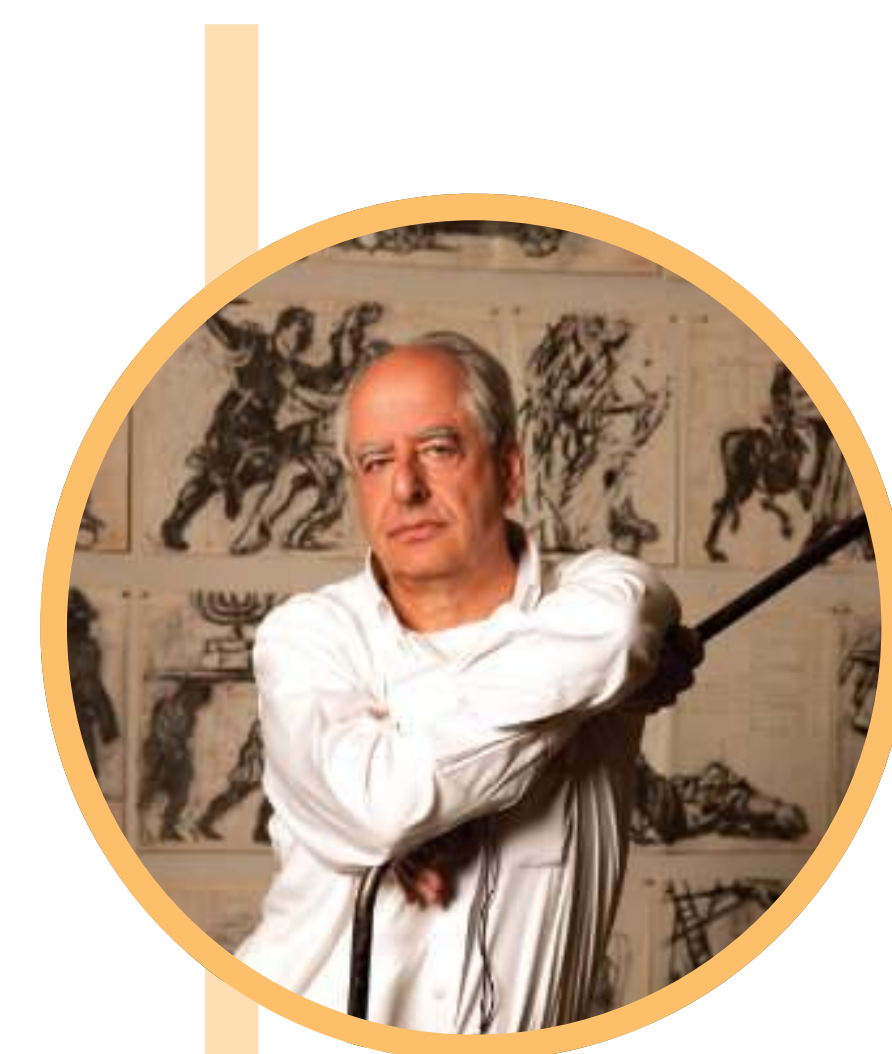


the chosen artefacts

We were tasked with selecting and drawing inspiration from a temporary art exhibition [Artology Exhibition] in the museum, identifying connections between the artworks. I focused on three artworks that were produced by contemporary multi-media artists that shared interest in motion pictures. Through their work, these artists explore confronting and provocative themes, addressing pressing contemporary issues in South Africa.



phasing timeline



Month 01

William Kentridge

Theme:

Socio-political conditions of post-apartheid.



Month 02

Johan Thom

Theme:

Daily experience of life in South Africa – from different cultural traditions and philosophies.



Month 03

Justice Mukheli

Theme:

What it means to be African.

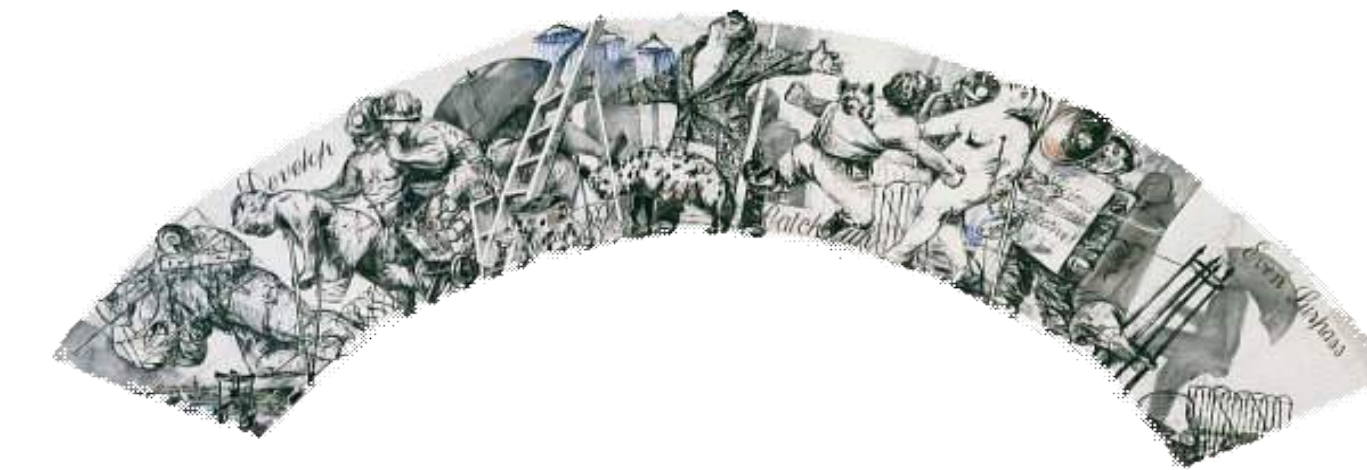


An exhibition space for other film artists

[work can be digitised and displayed on the screens for non-film artists].

art content

Physical body of work



"Arc/Procession"

Medium – charcoal and pastel
Size – 900x400mm



"Procession"

Medium – bronze sculpture [4 parts]
Size – 200x200x300mm



Series "6 themes"

Medium – aquatint and dry-point
Size – 500x650mm

Motion picture

Large film screening

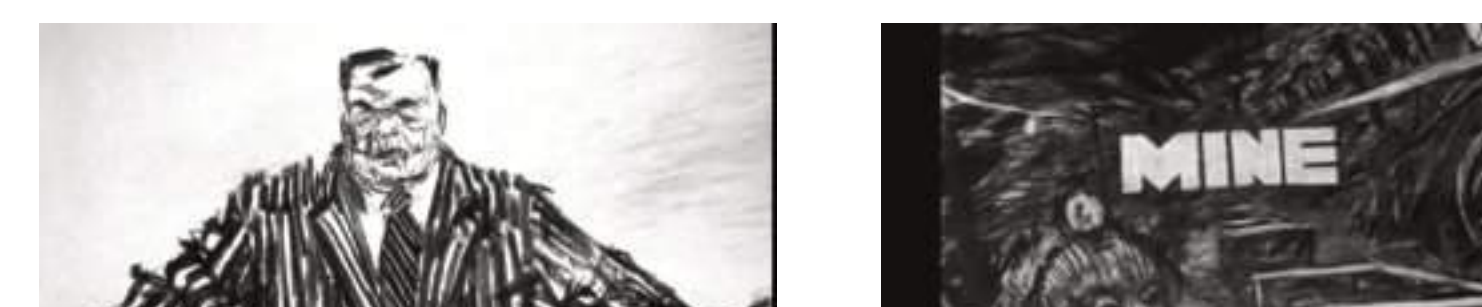


"Macabre Procession" (8 screens)

30 mins

[events]

Smaller enclosed film screening



"On Johannesburg"

"Mine"

10-15 mins

[starts when motion is sensed and used for time events]

Casual digital browsing screening



"Monument"

"Pain & sympathy"

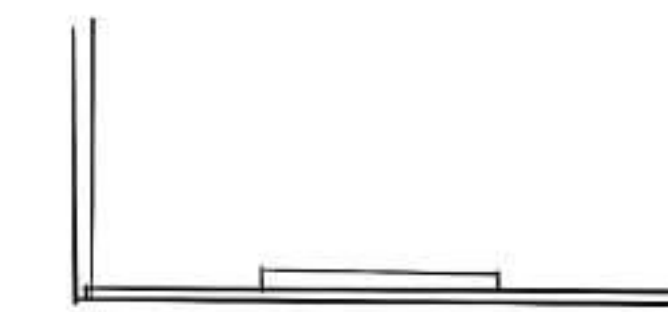
"Felix in Exile"

3-10 mins

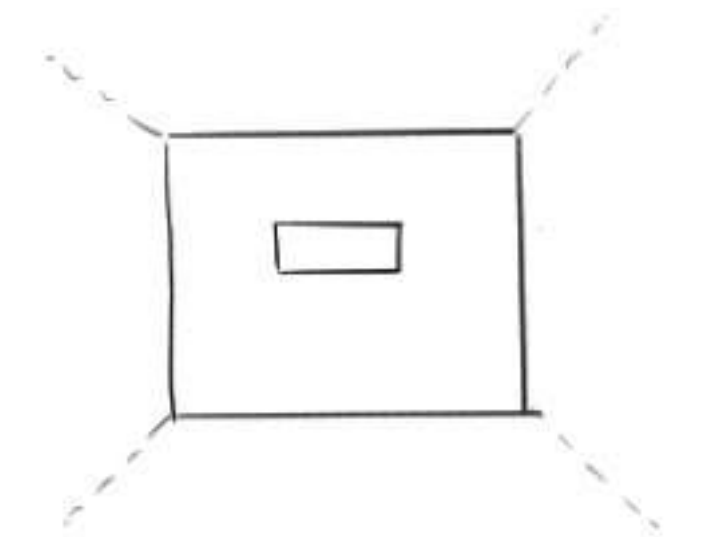
[starts motion] when

Display

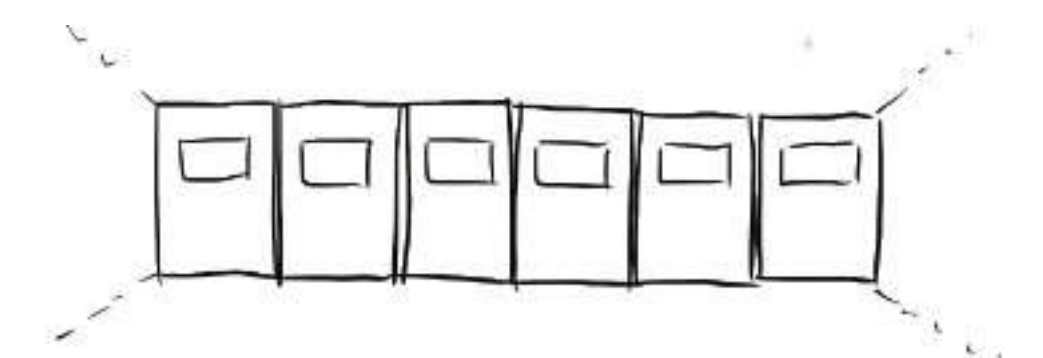
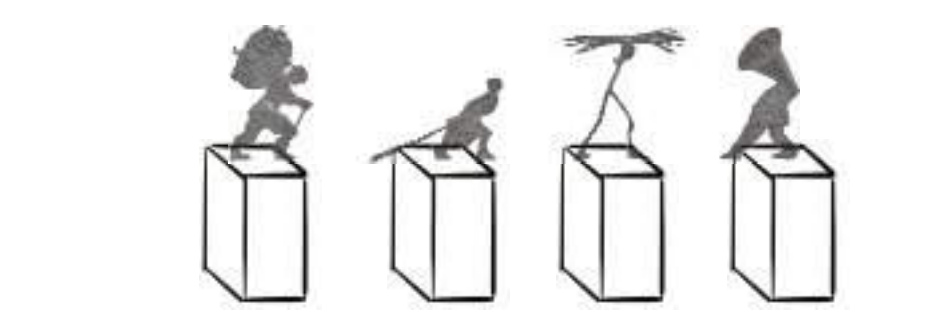
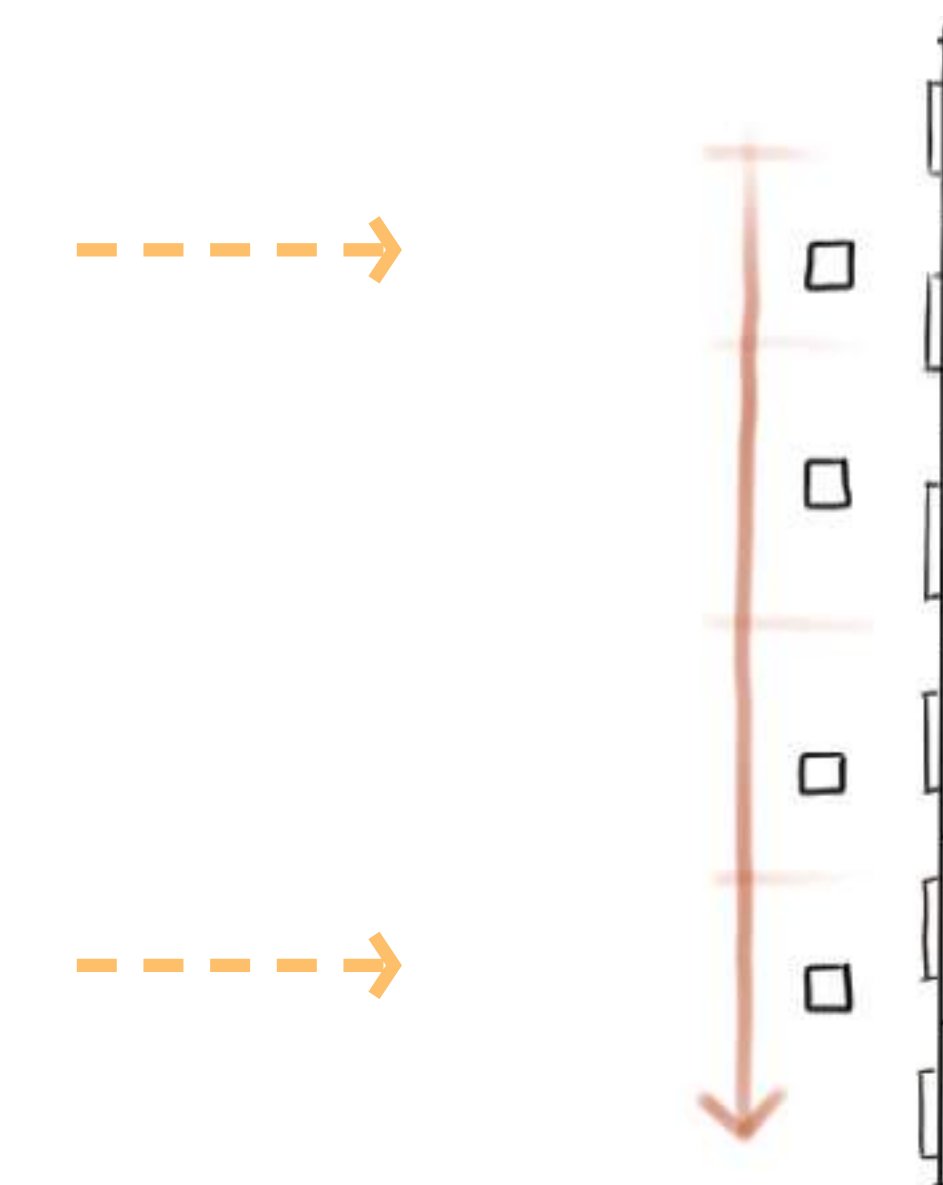
Plan view



Perspective

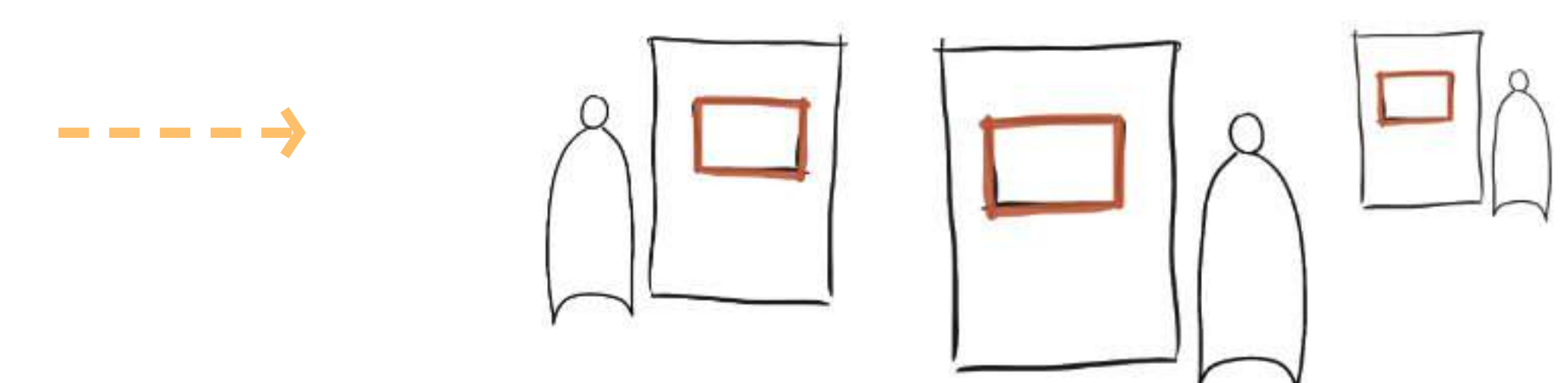
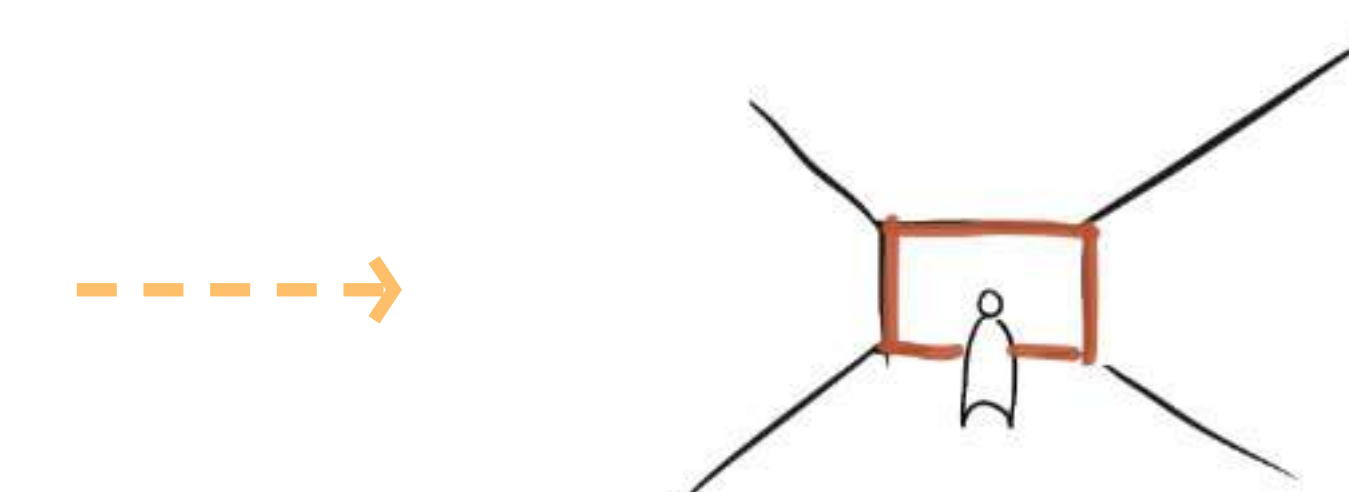
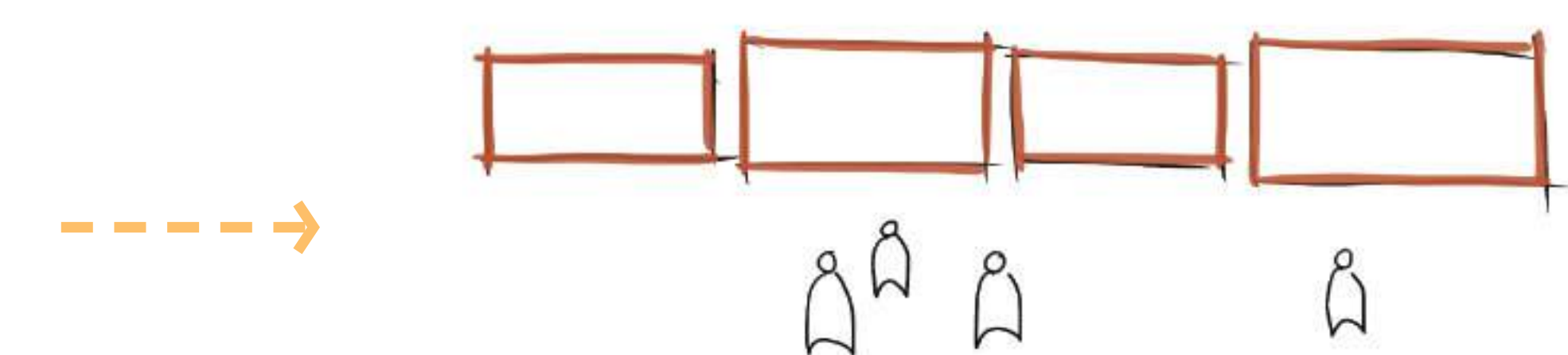


The Artology artefact is the object of focus that encourages visitor discussion and conversation.



Displayed in a linear layout to highlight the concept of work displayed – which is the idea of "procession".

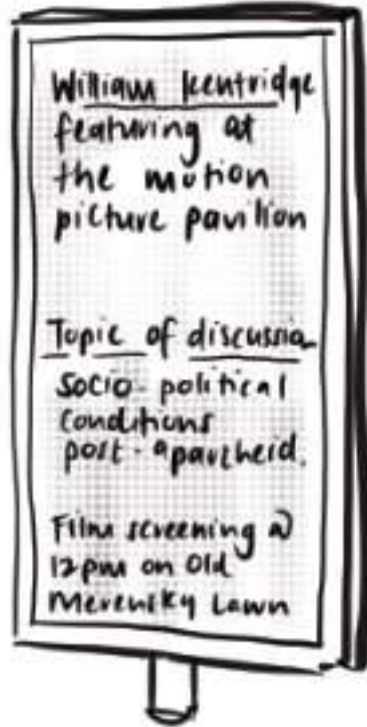
Generating movement and a journey of discovery through the exhibition.



Site Study

strategy & analysis

Hatfield campus, University of Pretoria
Art axis & surrounding cultural buildings.



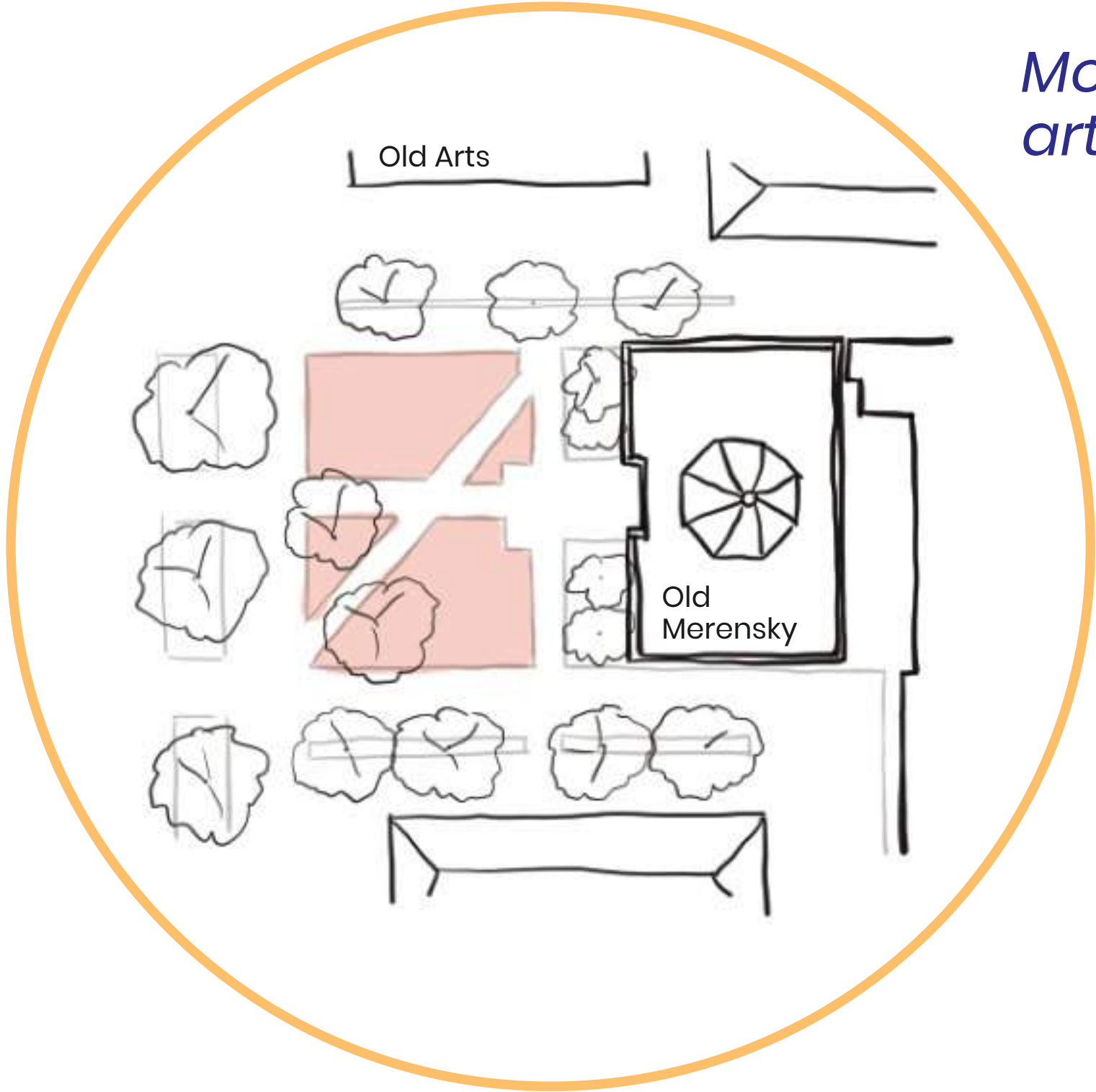
Digital advertising screen strategy

Digital screens scattered along the art axis describing the programme, artist and topics of discussion within the pavilion.

- Old Arts Museum
- Music Department
- Old Merensky Museum
- Chosen location of pavilion**
- Art Axis [Tukkie Laan]
- Visual Art Department
- Architecture Department
- Art Center

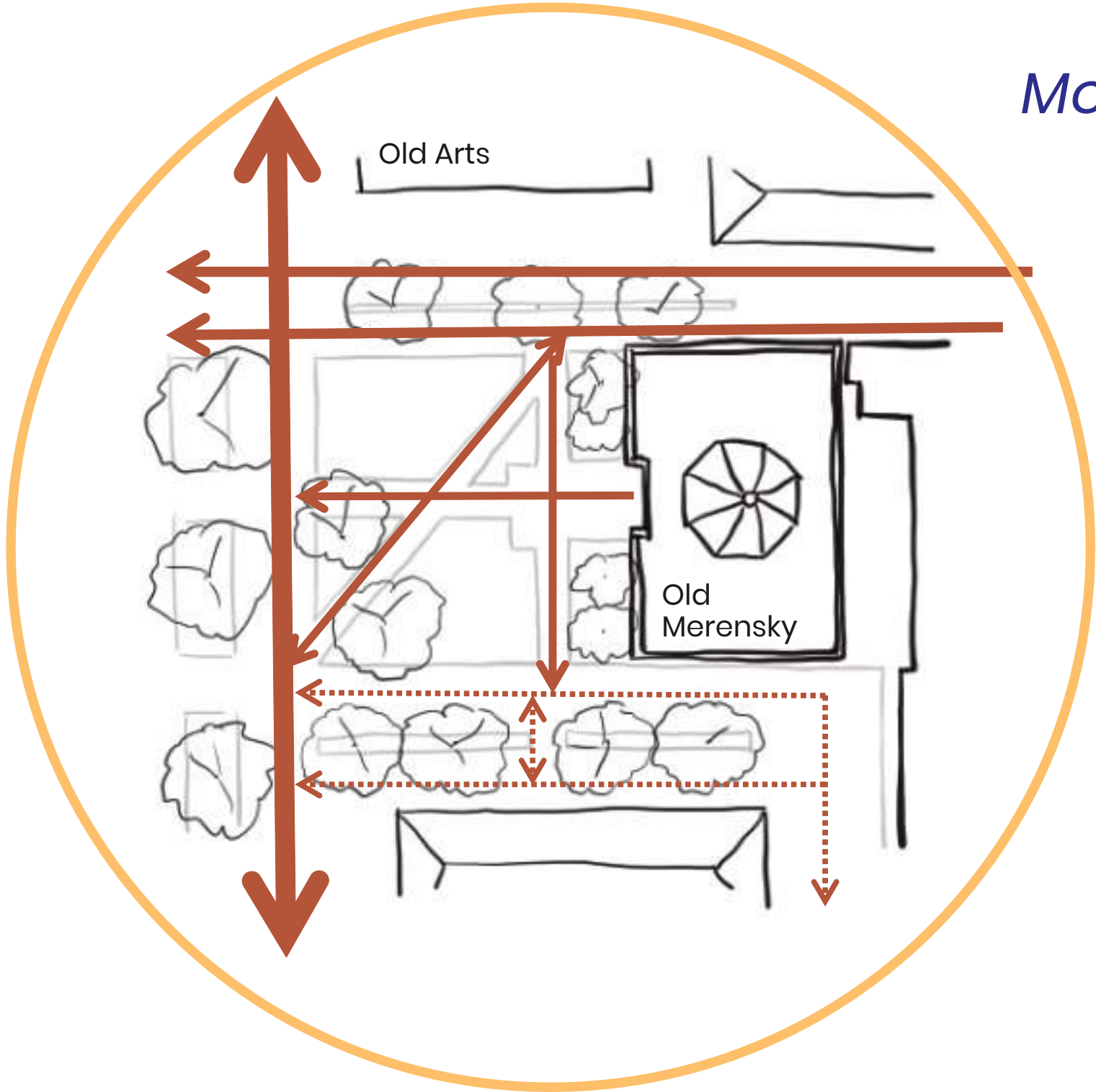


micro-site analysis



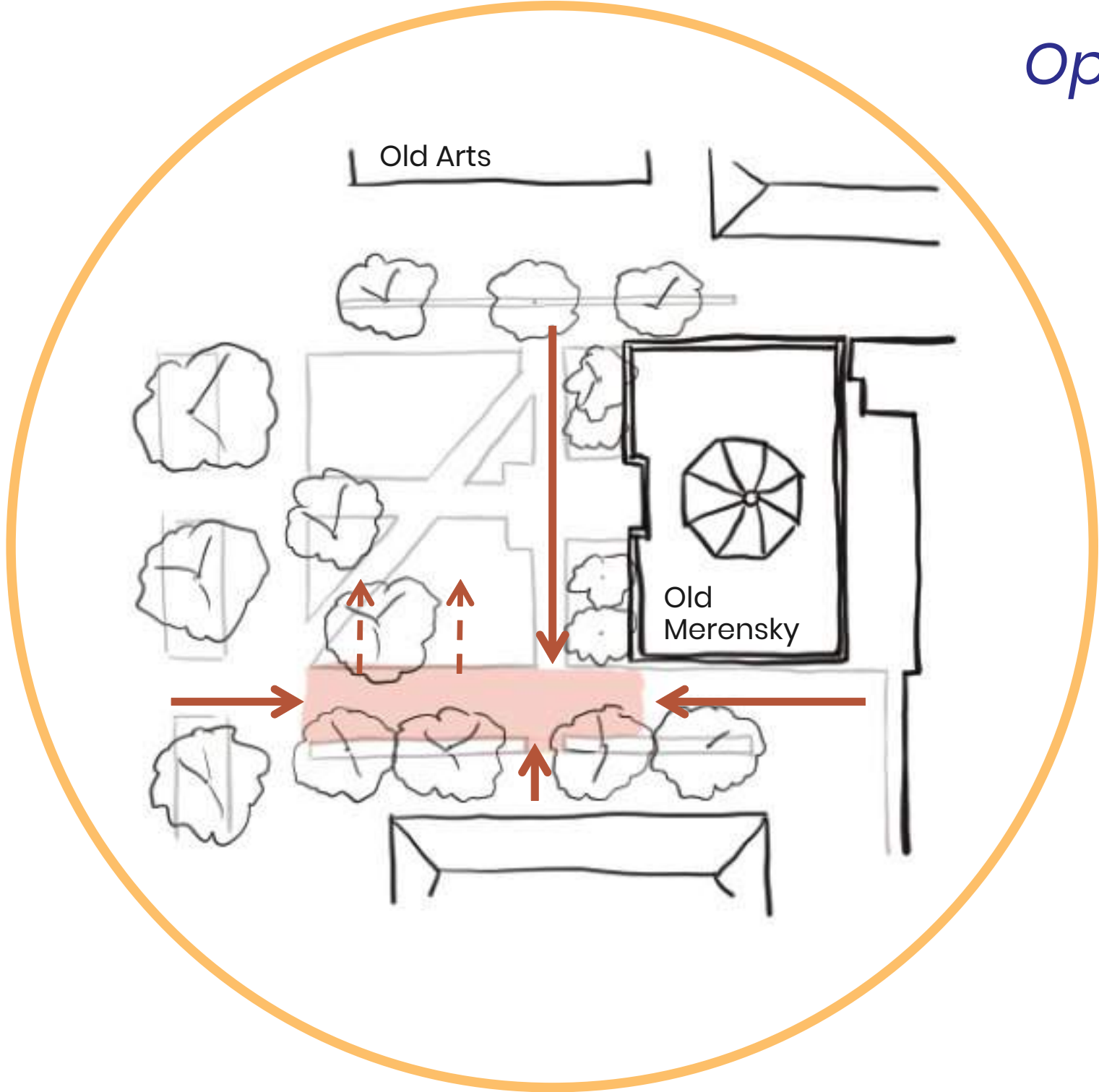
Monumental artefacts and lawn

Significant site to attract visitors to museum and make better use of the lawn in front of the Old Merensky.



Movement

Attracting people to low areas of movement.

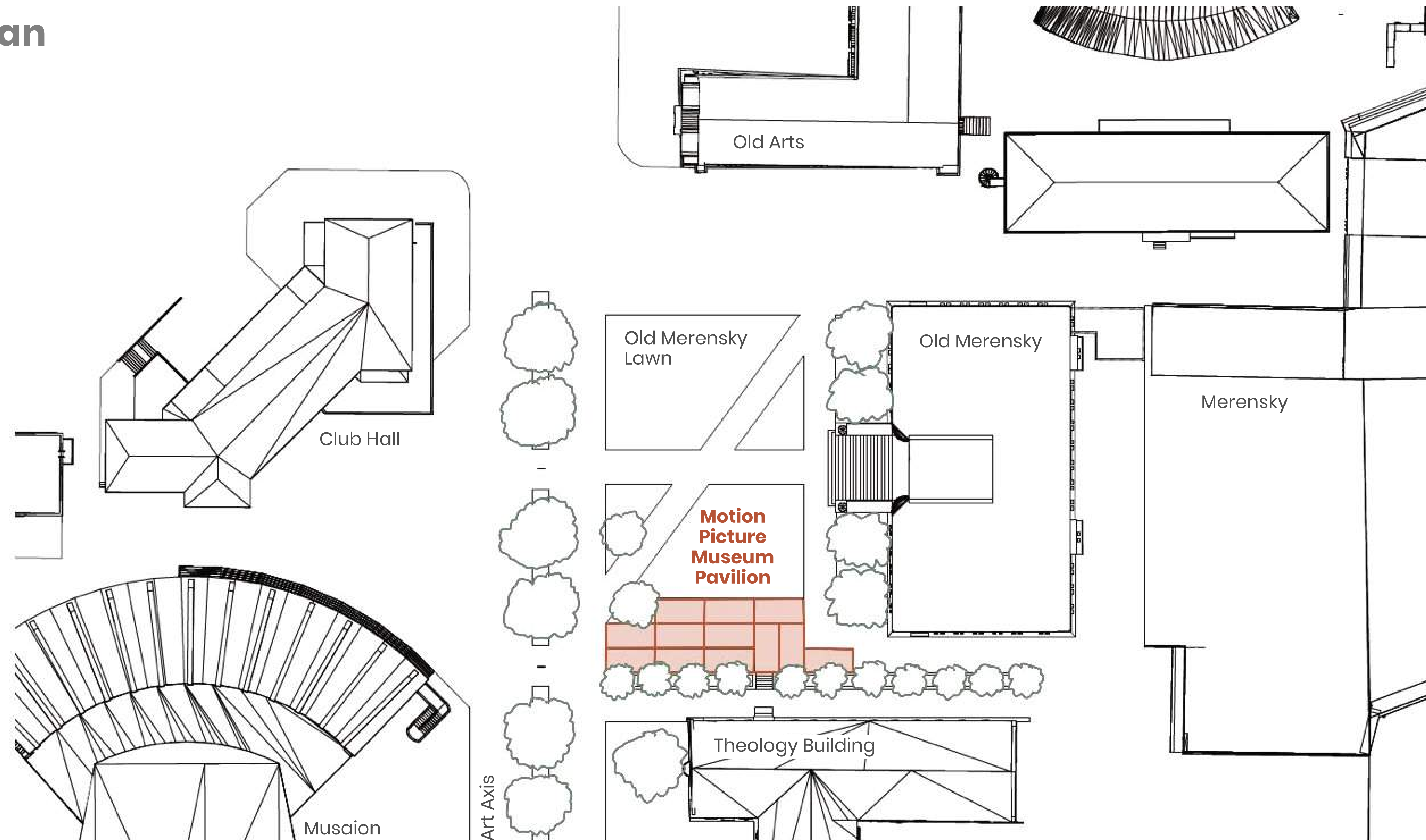


Opportunity

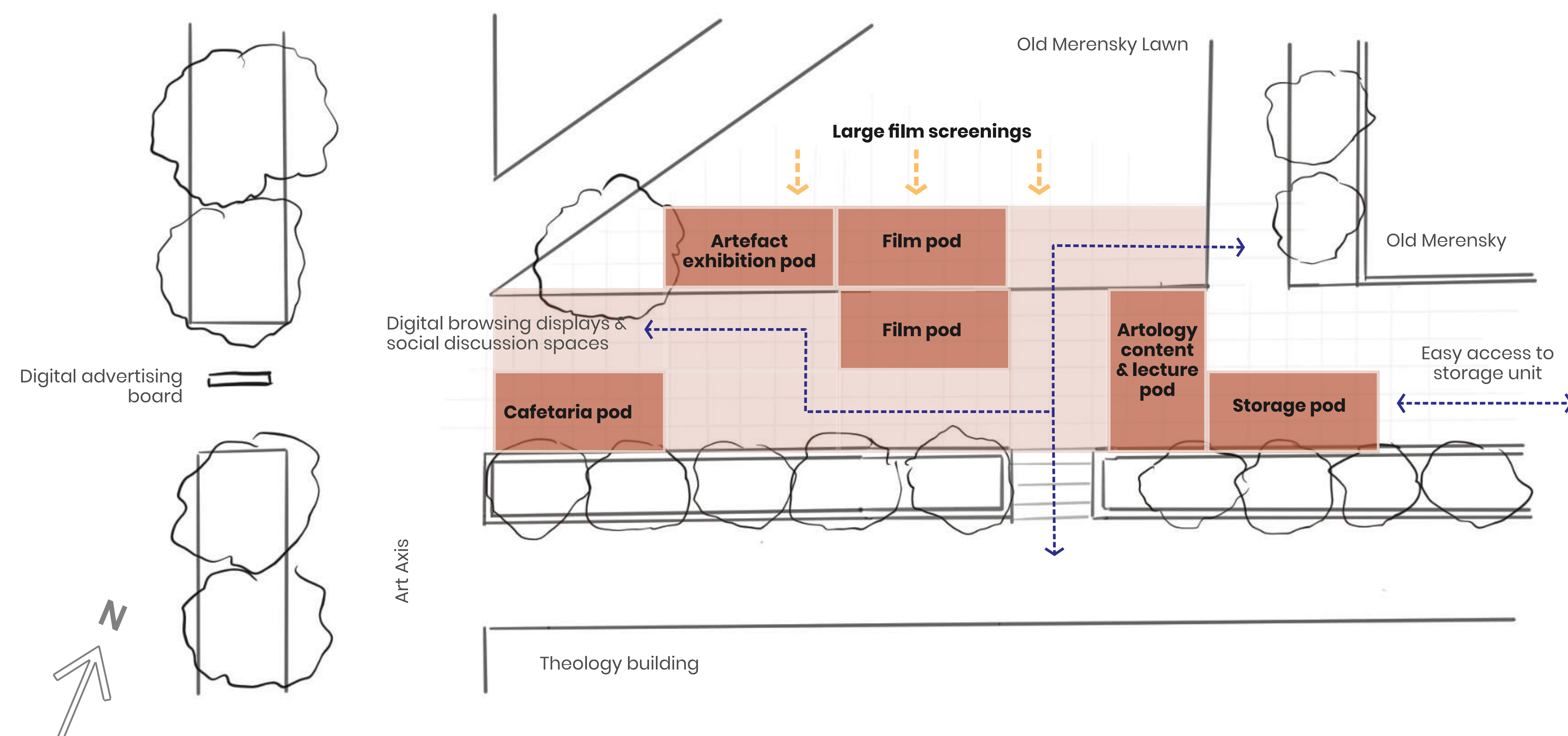
Repurposing dead space for the pavilion. It is also adjacent to high traffic area.

location

site plan



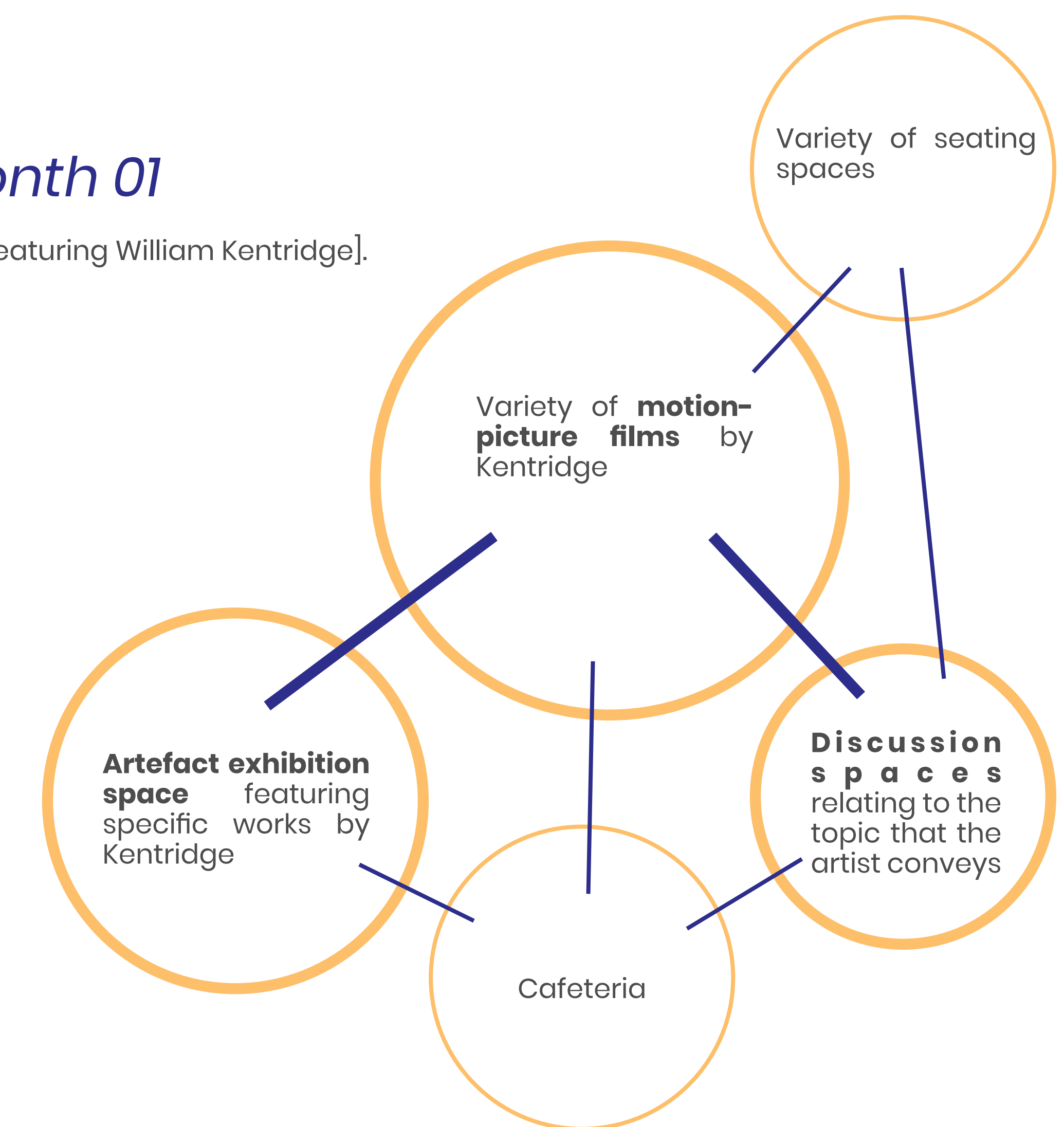
zoning



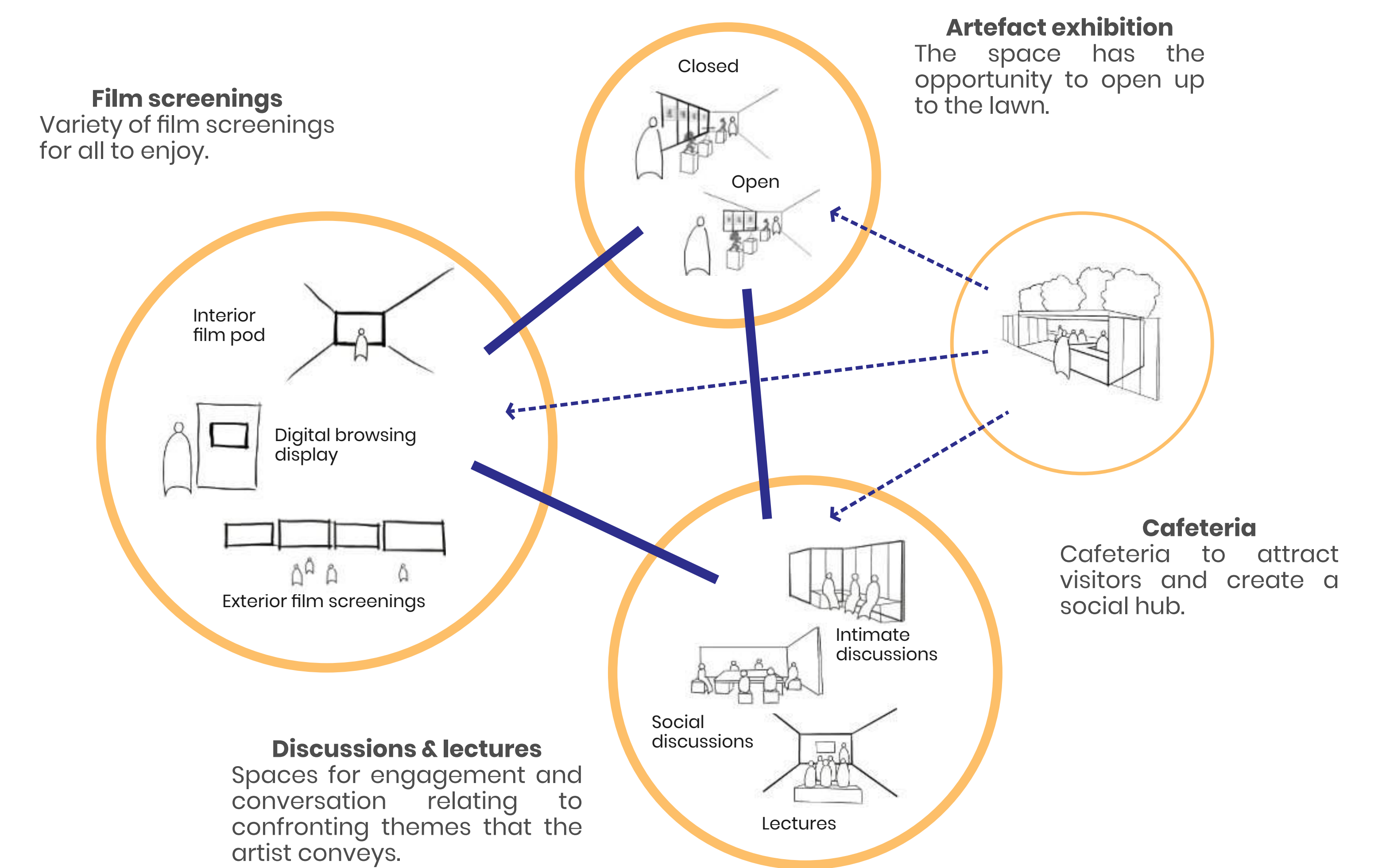
programming

Month 01

[Featuring William Kentridge].



Programme Interface



Concept

the vision

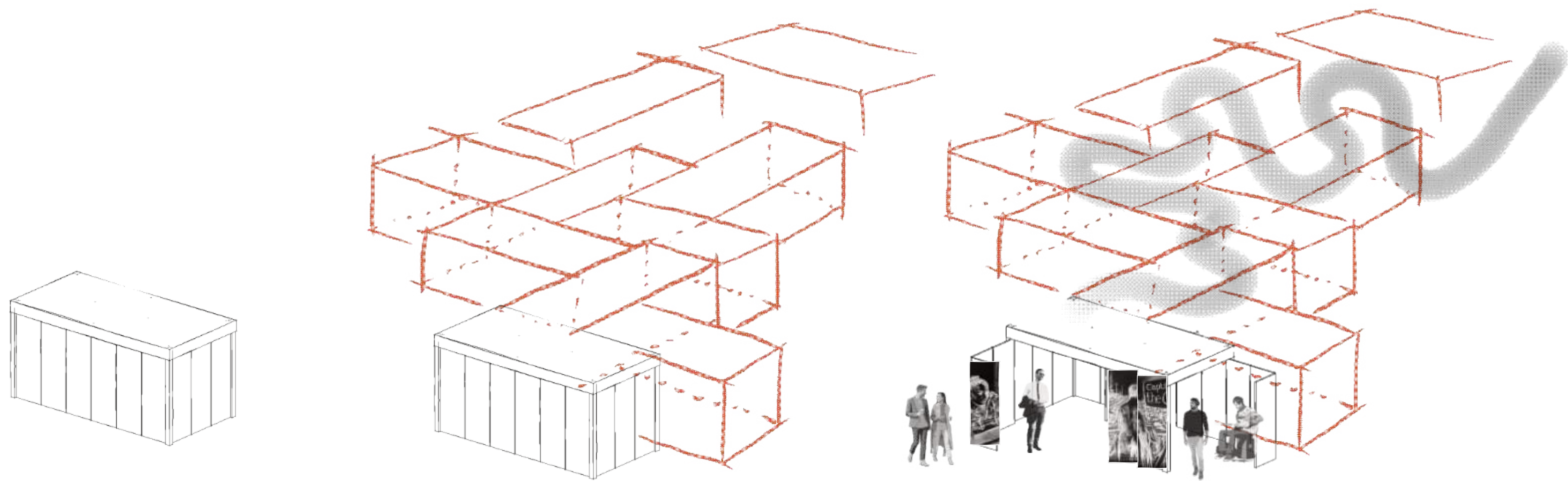
Attracting a younger generation of people – students at UP – through the concept of ‘motion-picture’ pods that uses *interactive and digital mechanisms* to promote *engagement* and *keep the heritage alive*.



design

A flexible panel system pod.

A coherent system of boxes comprised of 3-panel folding units that can adapt according to the programme requirements of the pavilion.



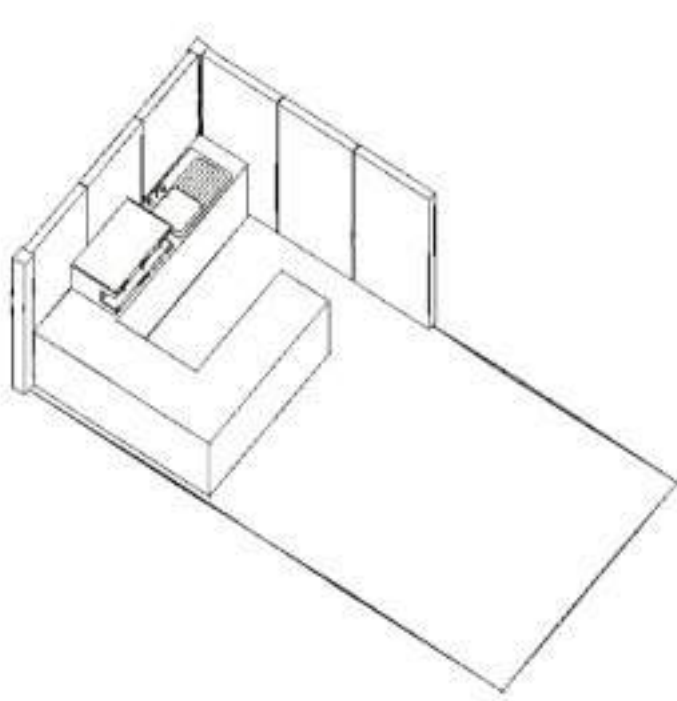
Component

System

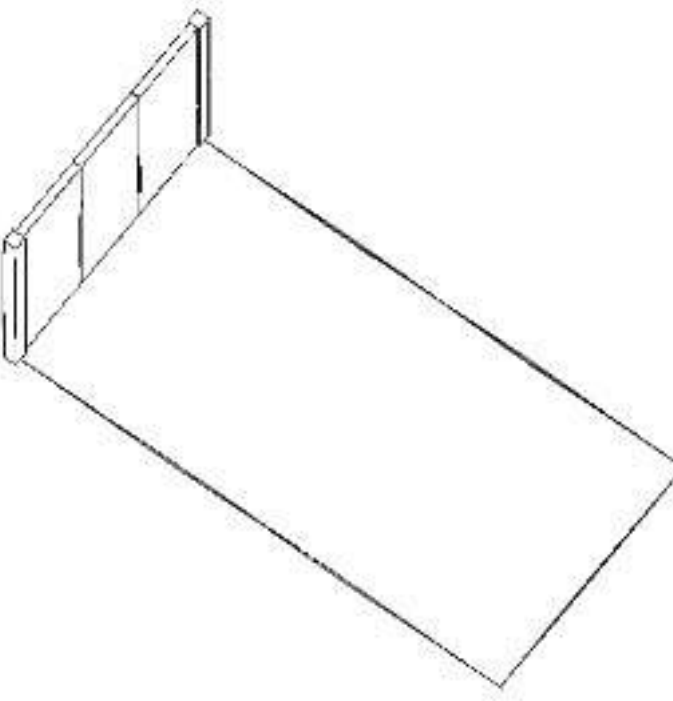
Adaptable System

fixed & adaptable panels

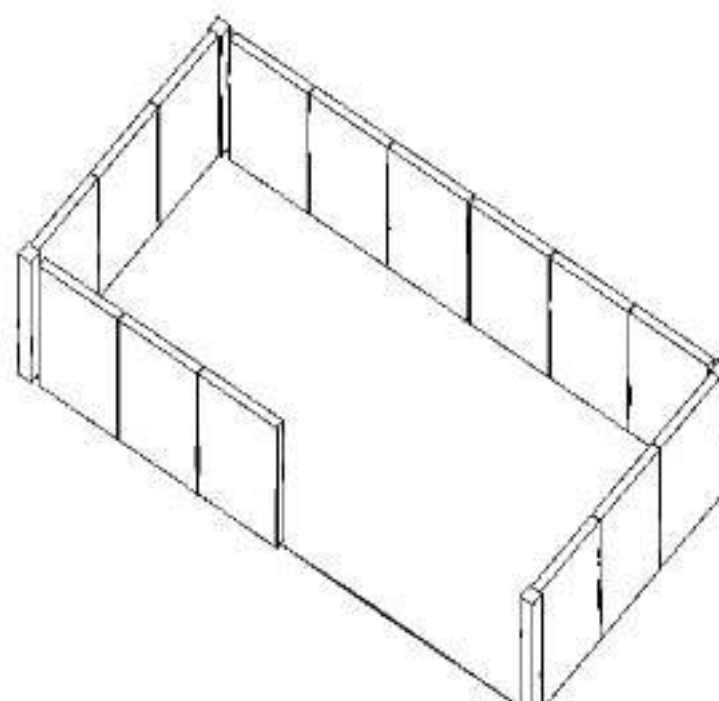
Fixed setup



Cafeteria

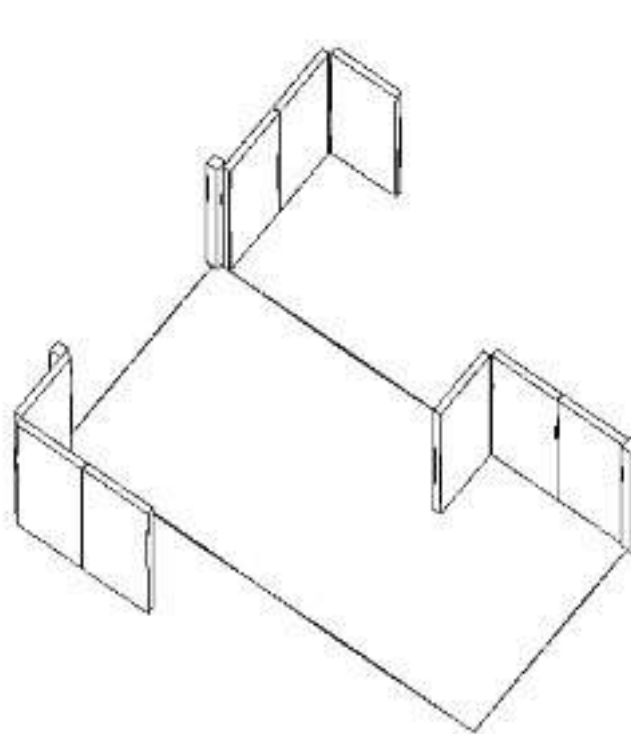


Artology
artefact

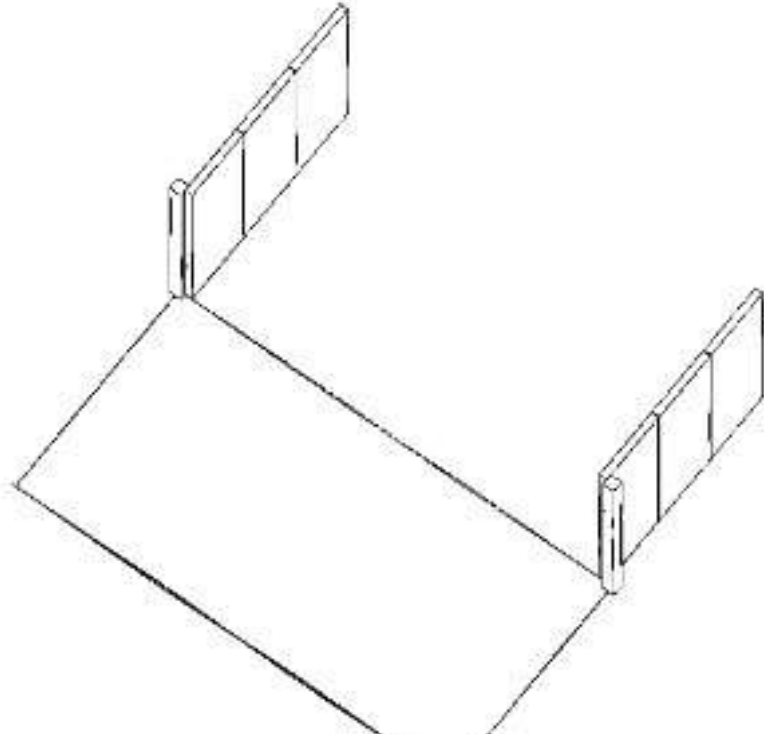


Storage

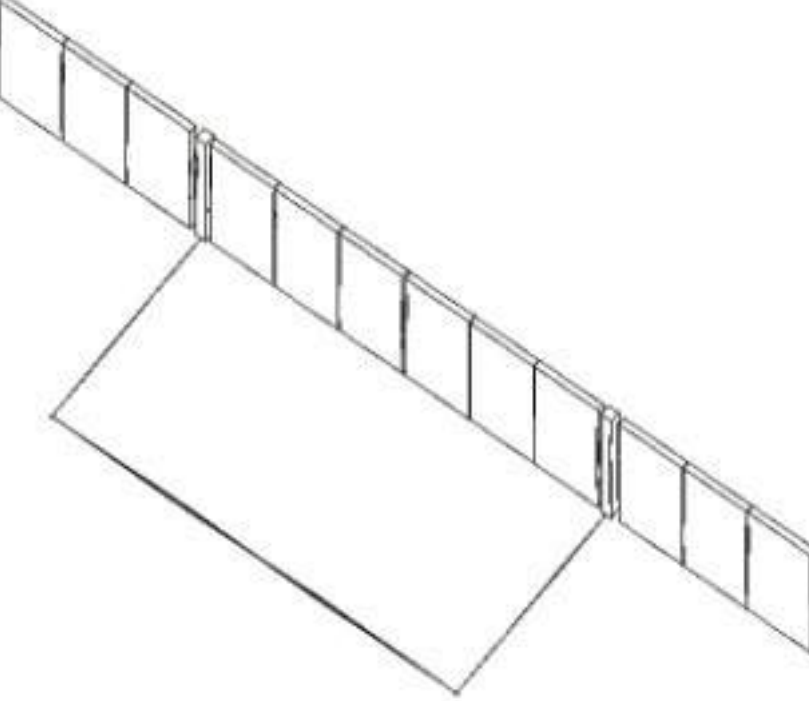
Adaptable setup



Intimate seating
arrangement and
small film screening



Exhibition
objects



Large film
screen

Design for Disassembly

the pod

The material palette consists of *dark materials that reflect a cinematic experience*.

The frame for the pod will consist of an *interlocking post and beam system*. Some pods will have a translucent polycarbonate roof sheet to create a light atmosphere whereas others will have a dark roof sheet with a suspended acoustic ceiling for indoor film screenings.



York Timbers black-stained plywood
Beam and post structure



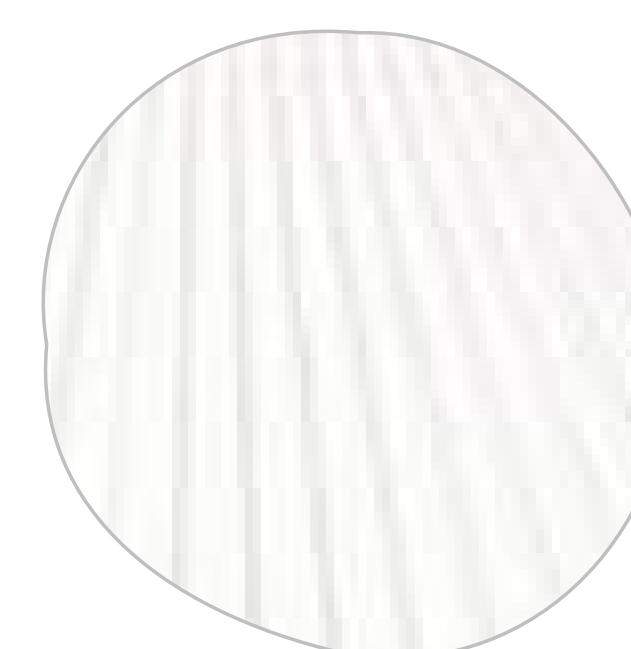
Black powdercoated steel track
Suspended steel ceiling grid



Raw Studio black-stained acoustic panels
To block out ambient noise in film and discussion pods



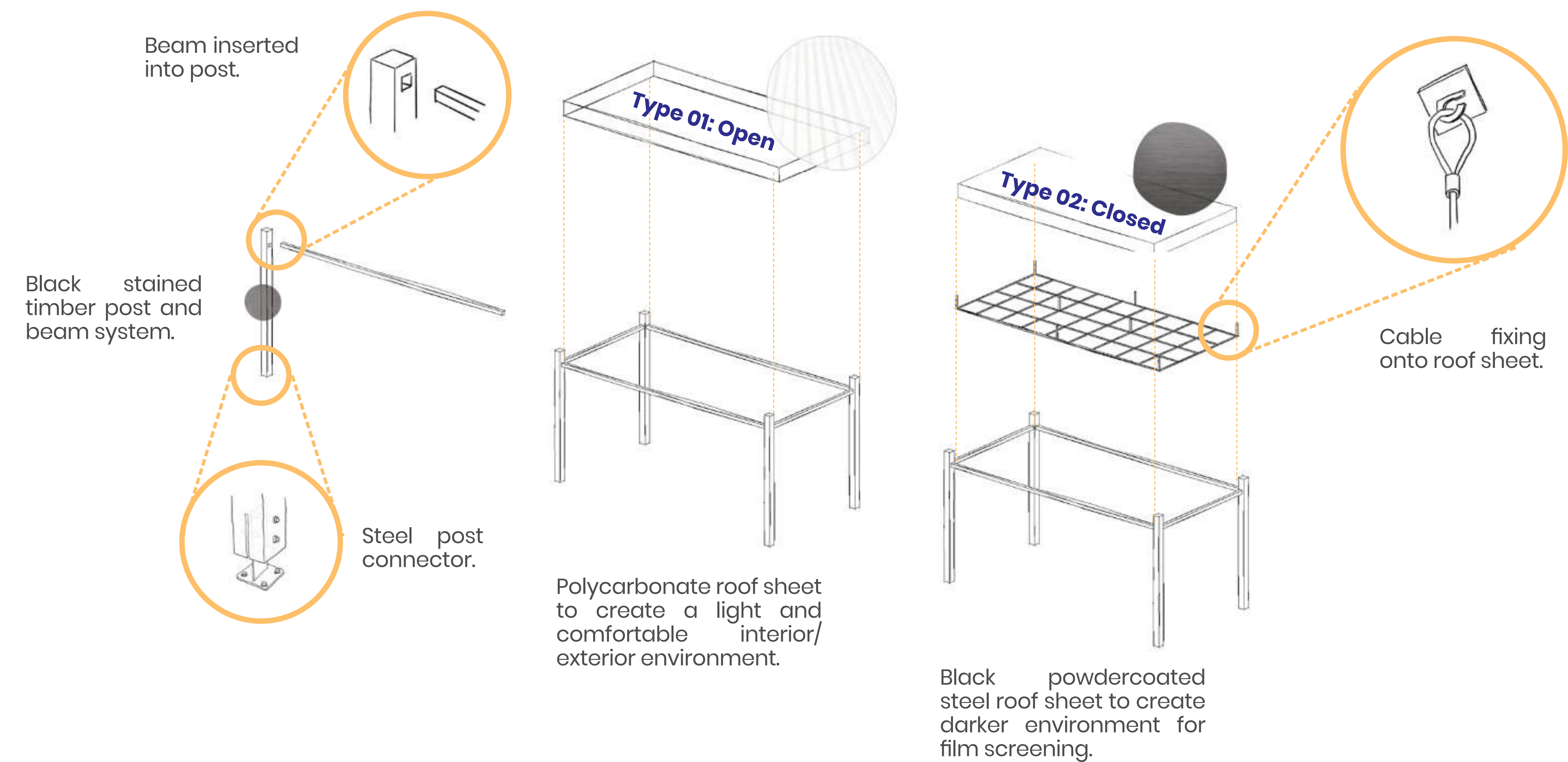
Black powdercoated steel sheet
Roof sheet



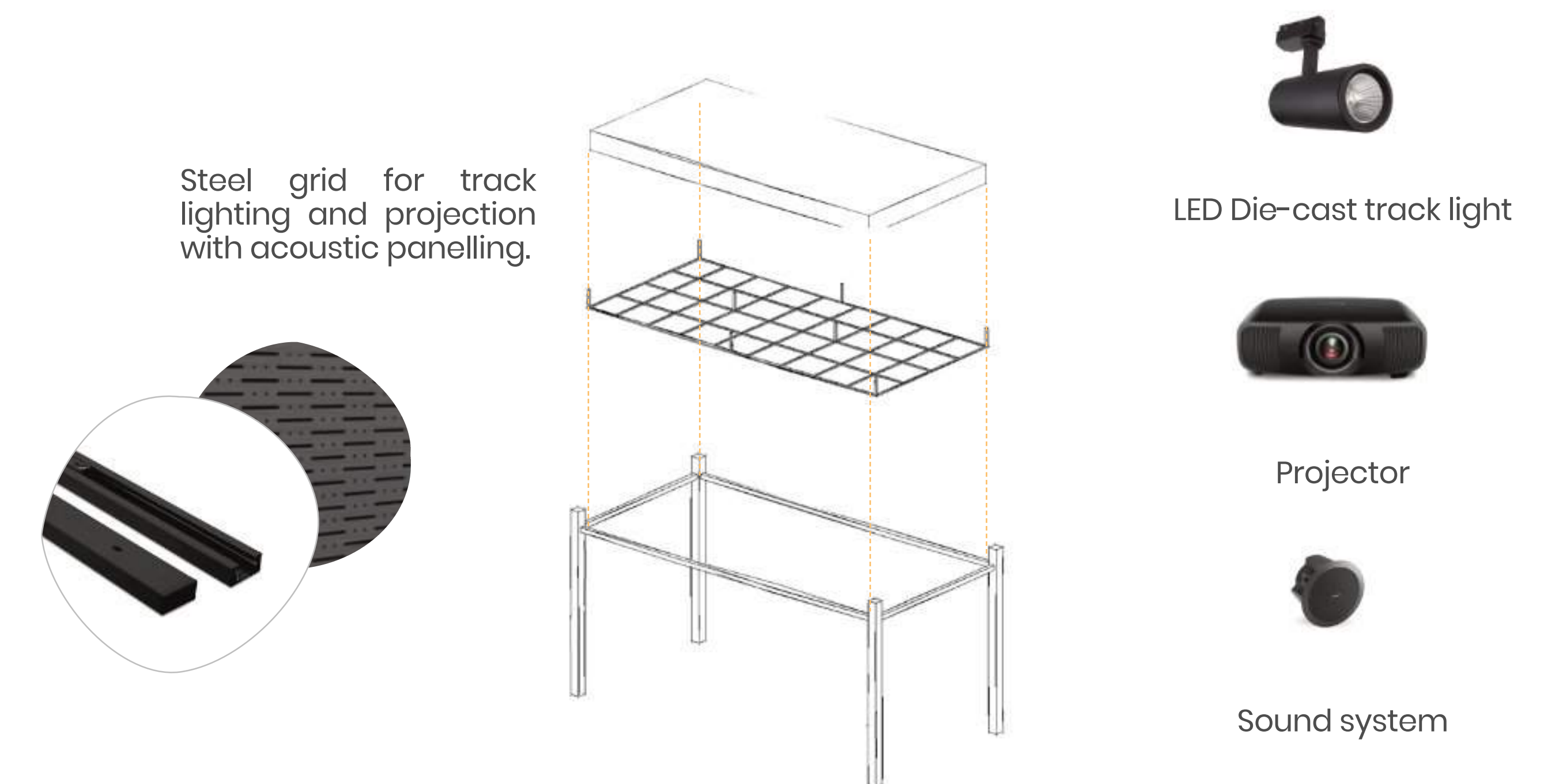
Polycarbonate sheet
Roof sheet

materiality
Roof system and structure [cinematic]

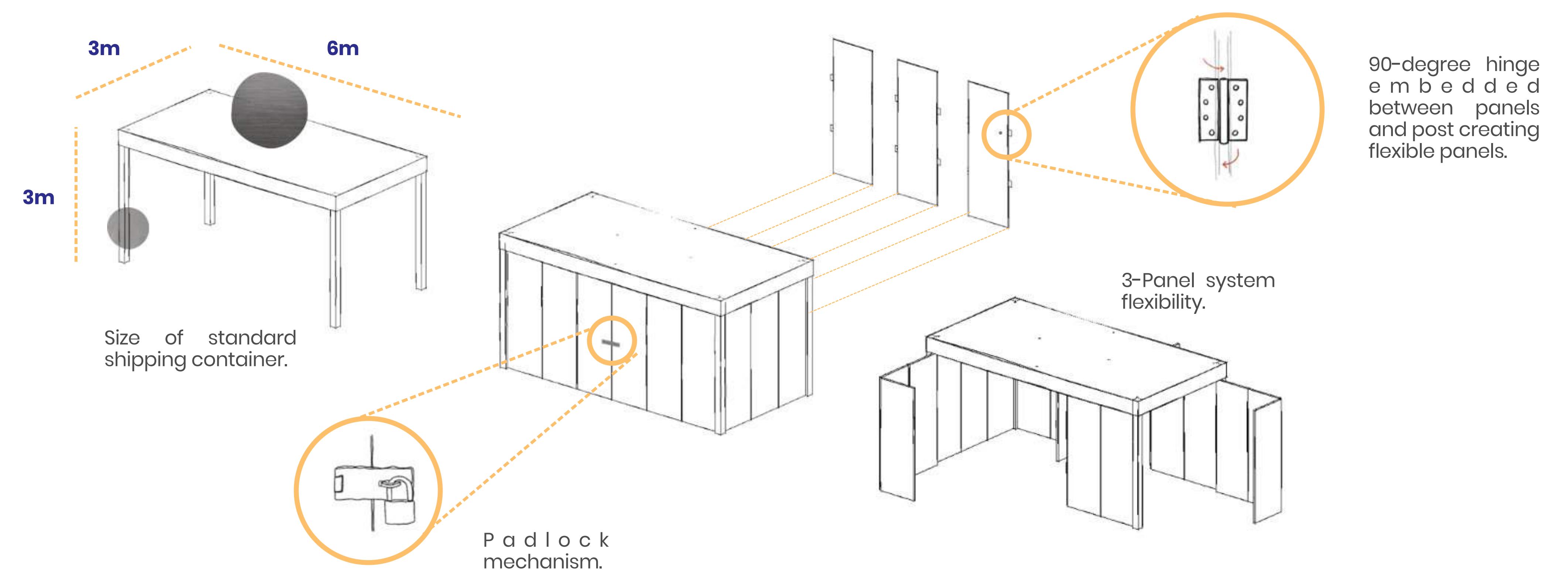
frame



suspended ceiling

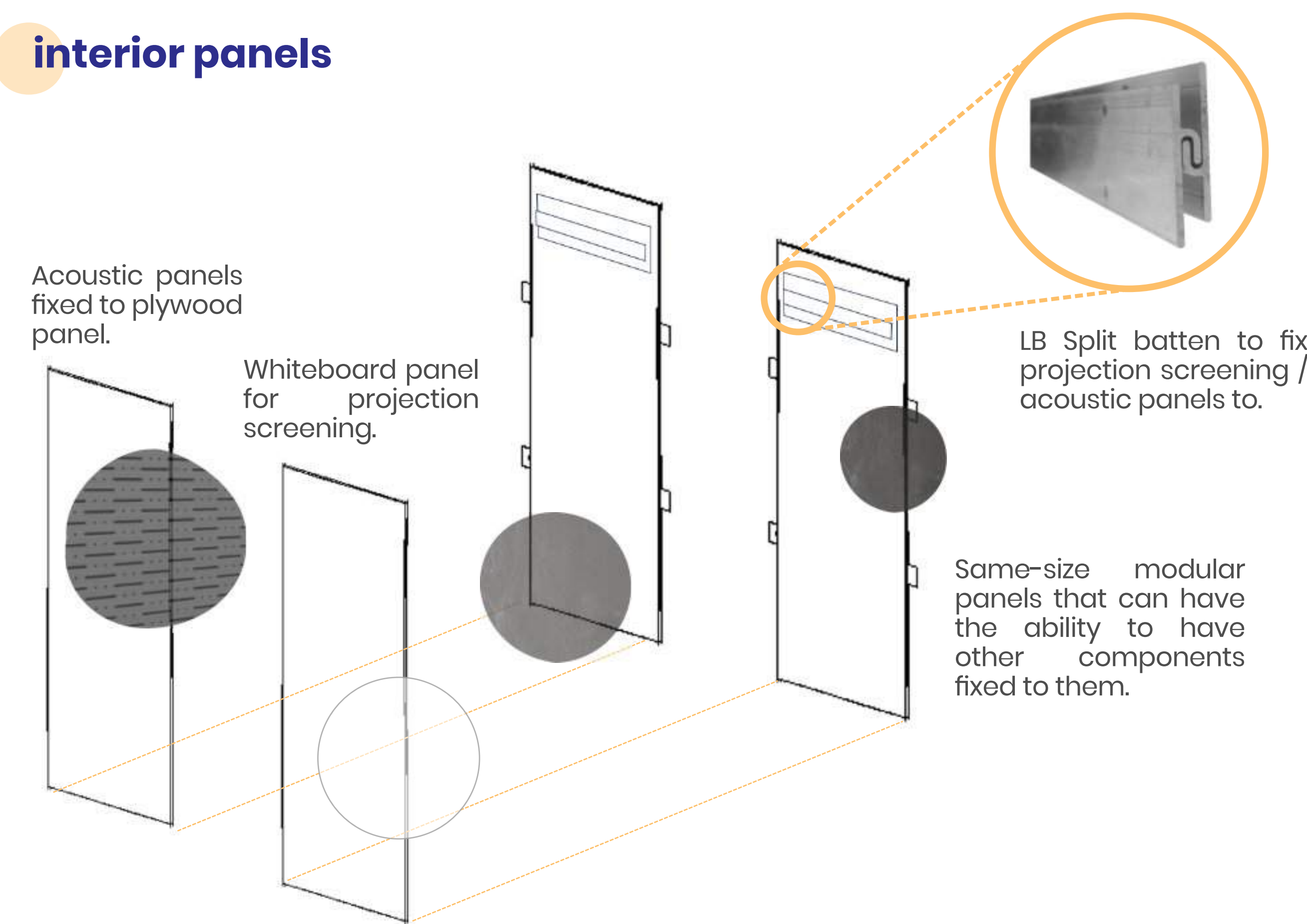


adaptable panel structure

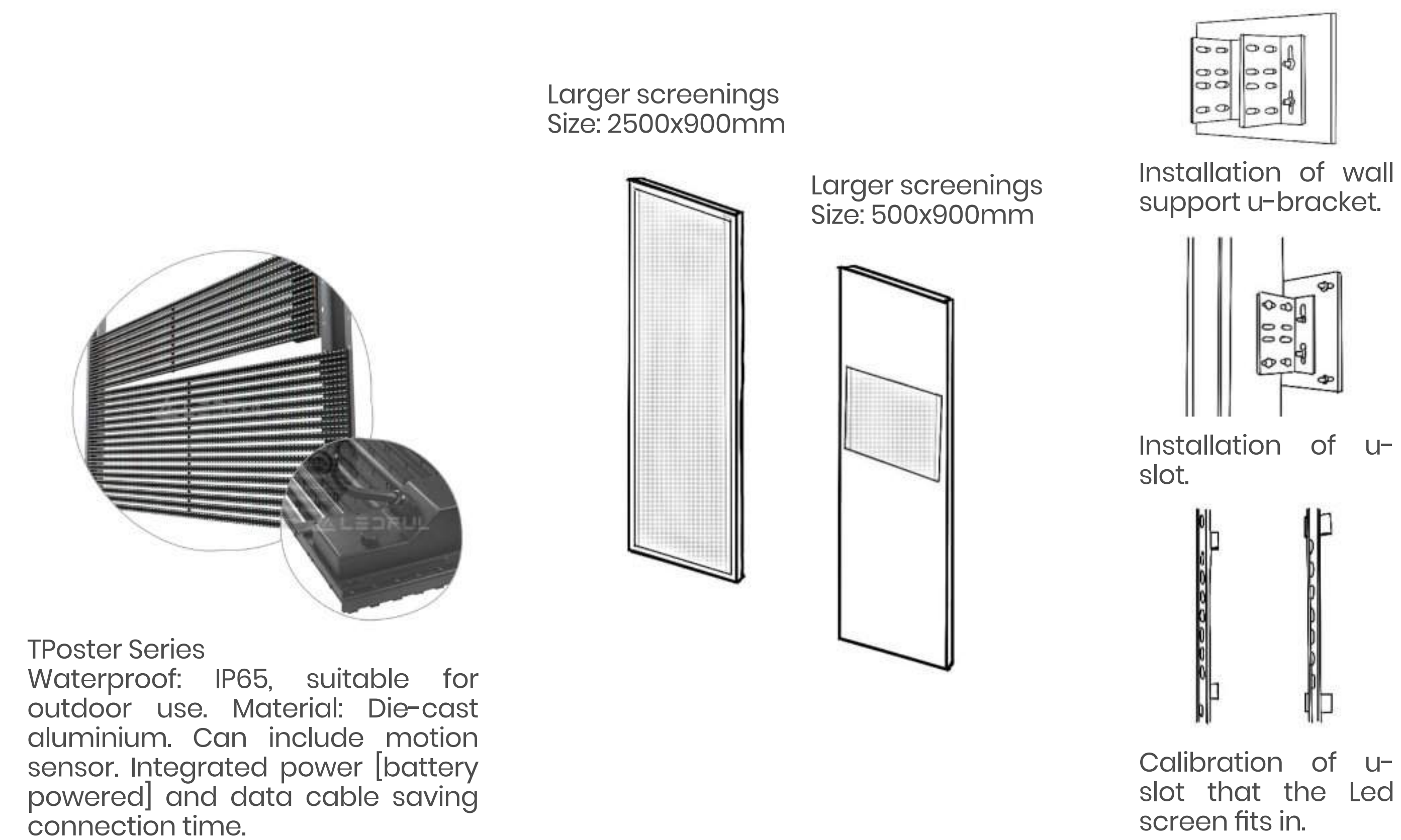


the panels

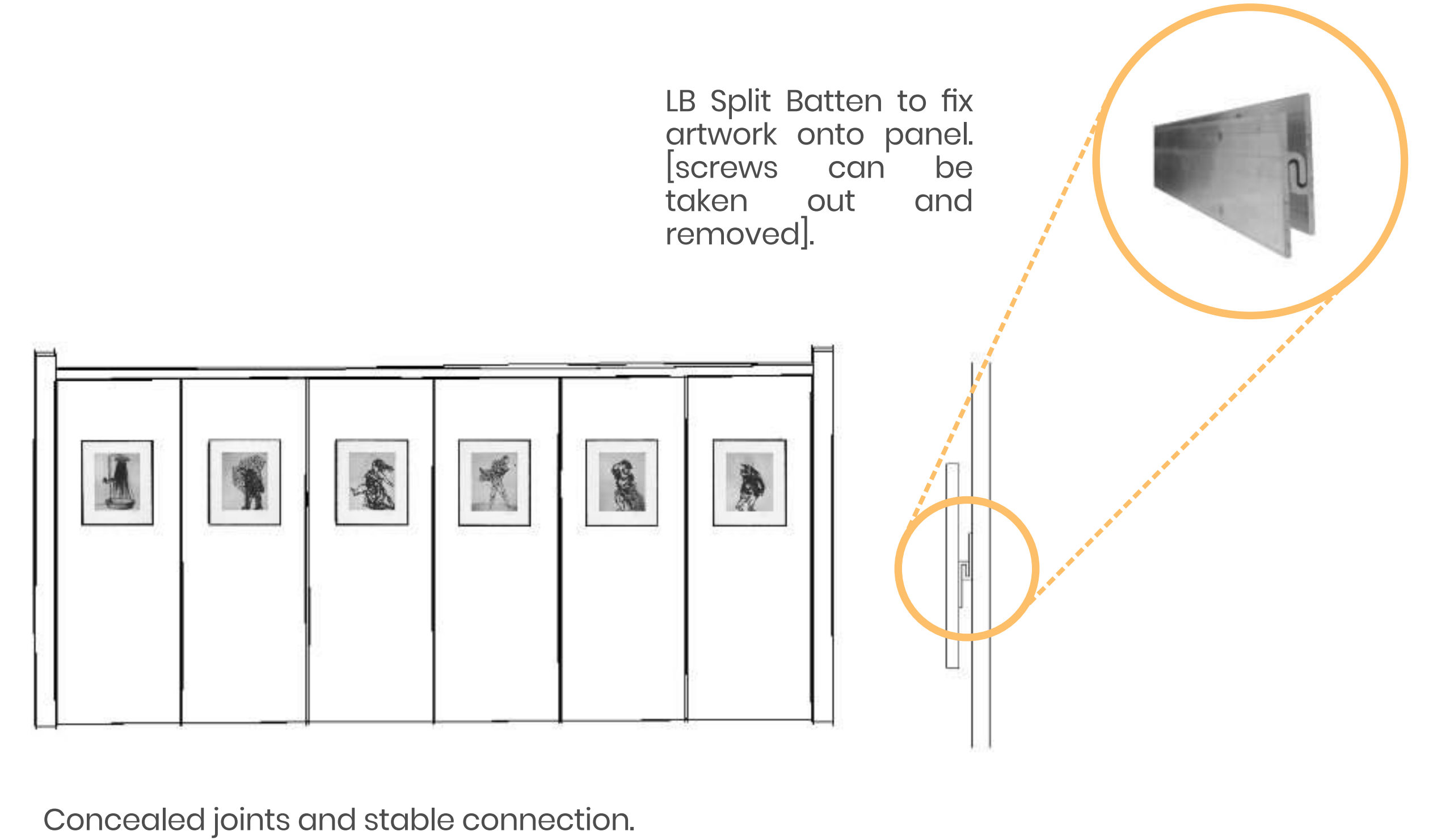
interior panels



exterior digital screening



art

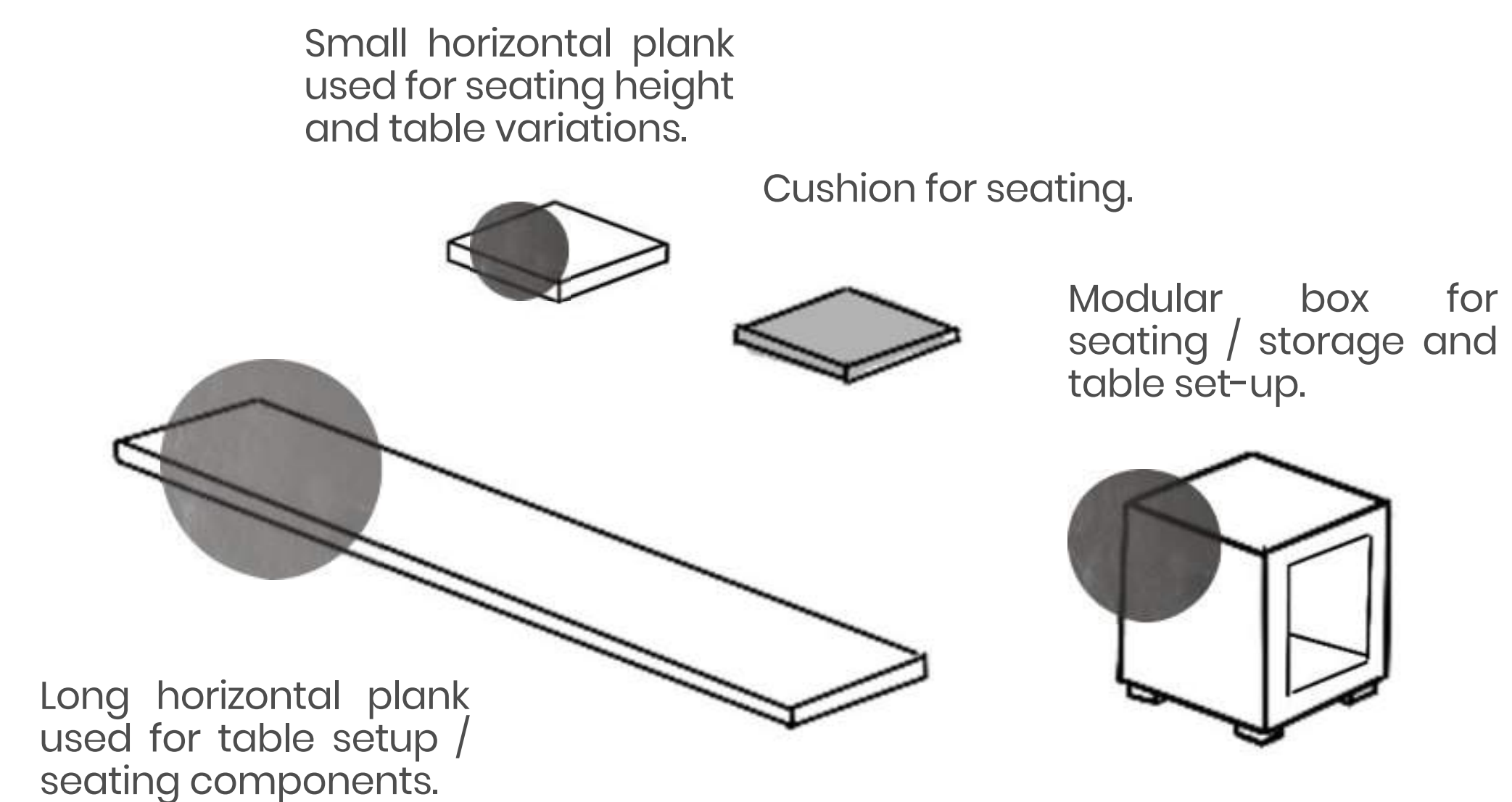


the furniture

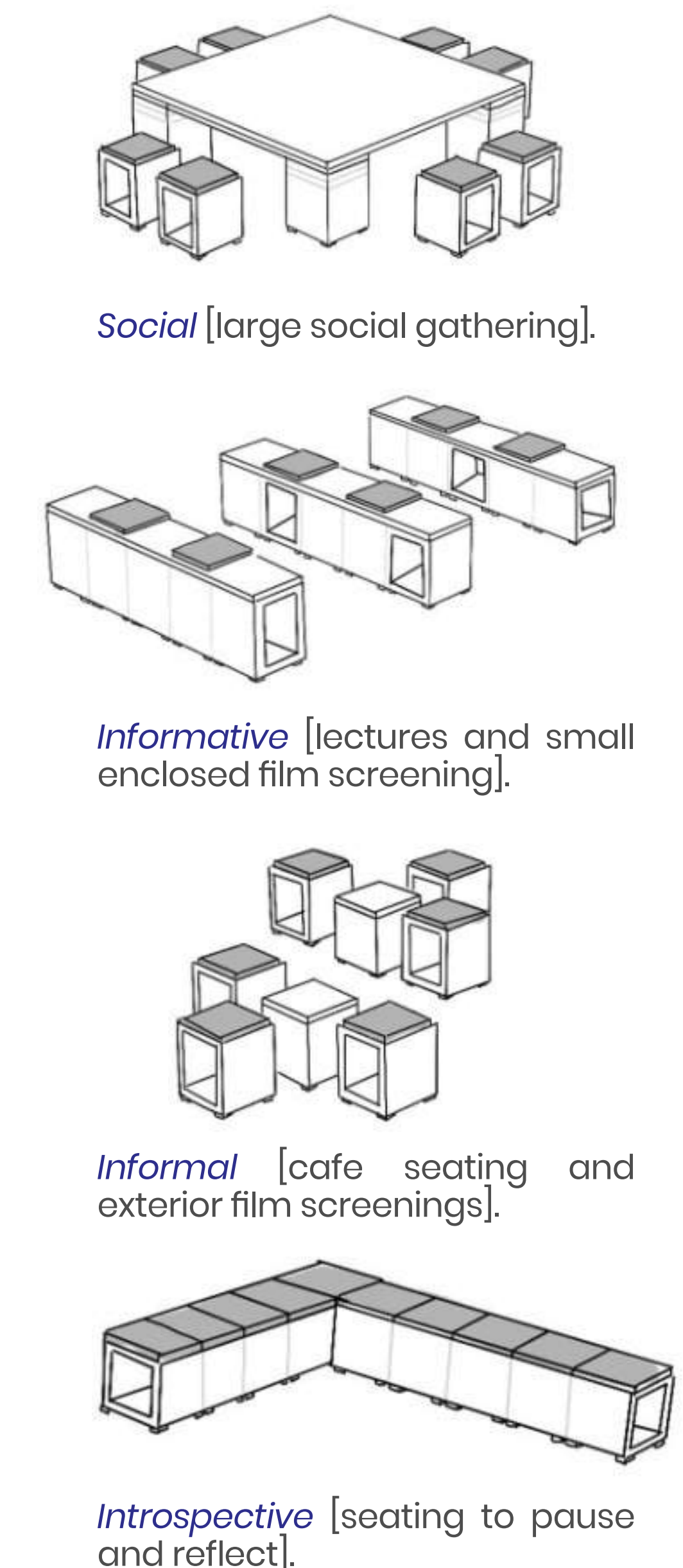
modular loose furniture

The loose furniture will be in the form of modular components that can be arranged in different formations to provide a social, informative, informal and introspective setting for visitors.

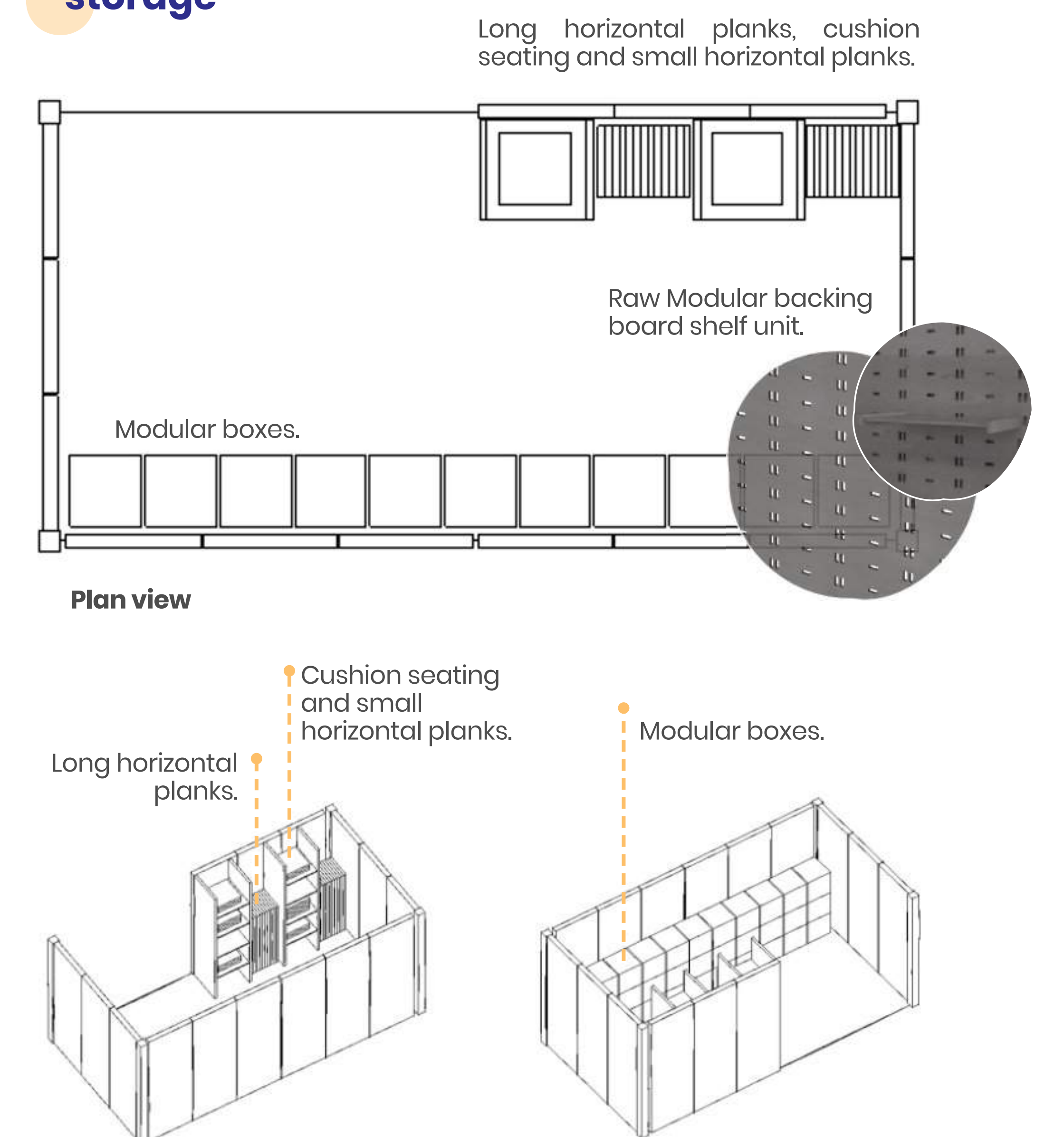
The modular design of the furniture can be easily packed into the storage pod after use.



layout variations



storage



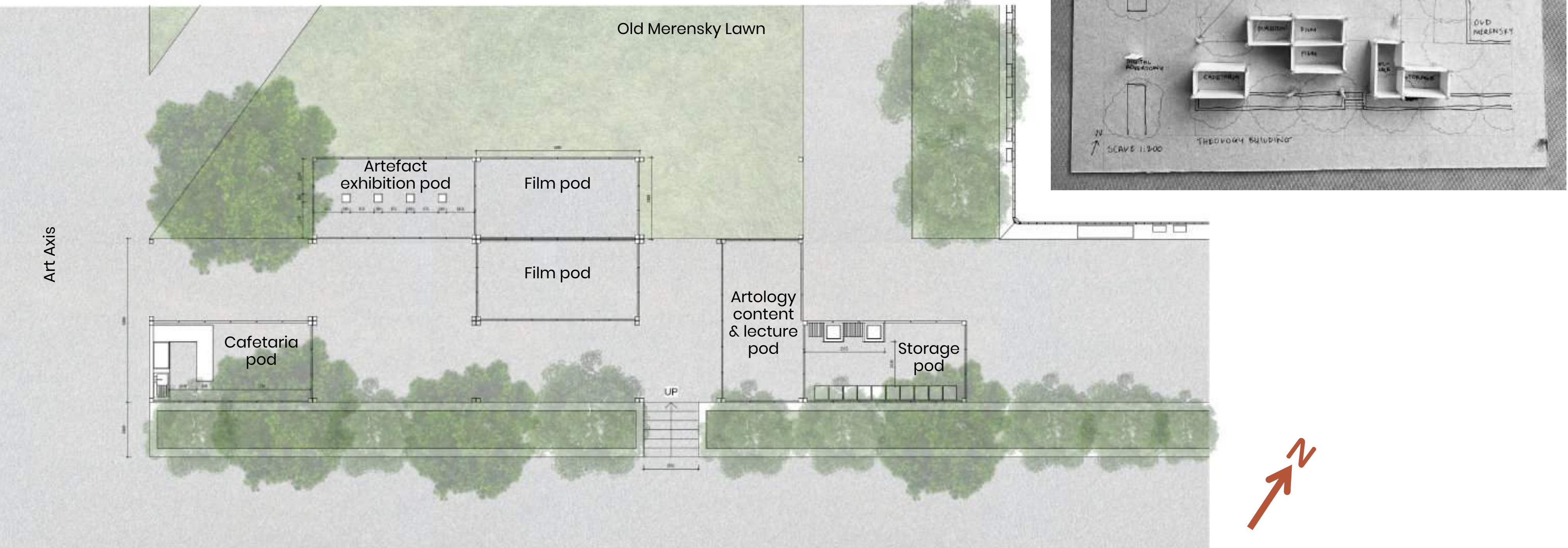
materiality
Adaptable panels [cinematic]



ground floor plan

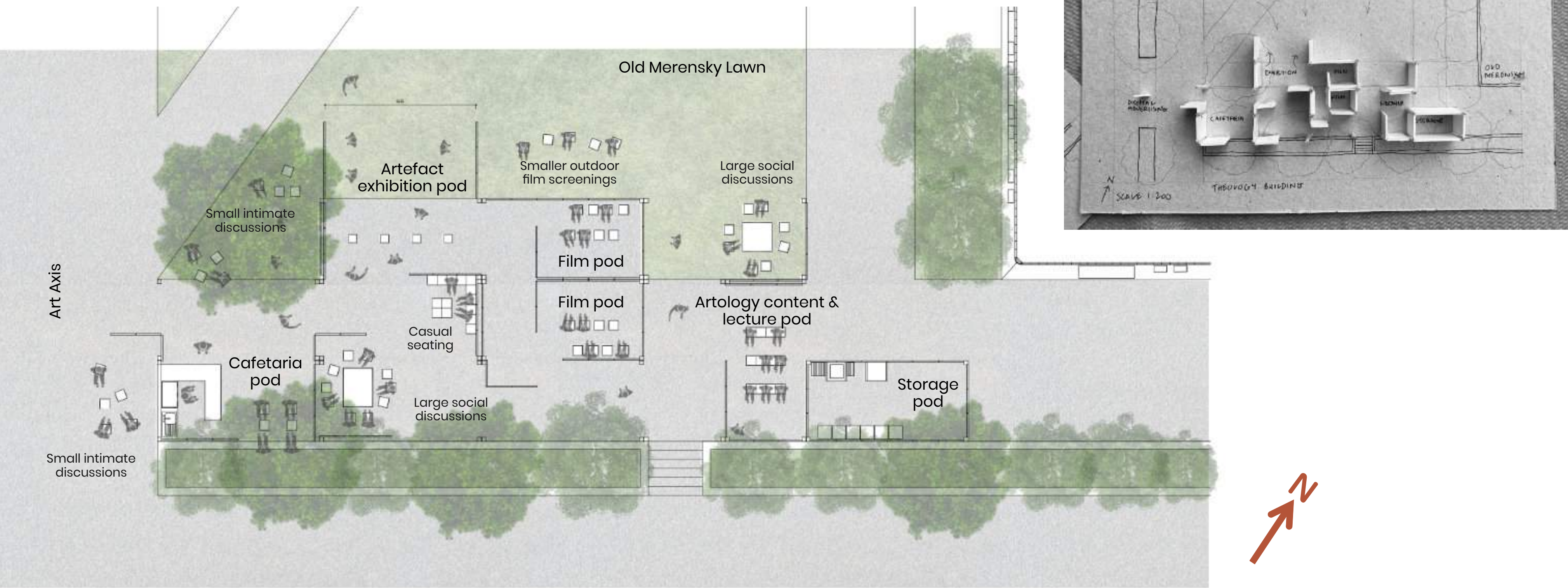
closed pavilion

At night [5pm-7am]



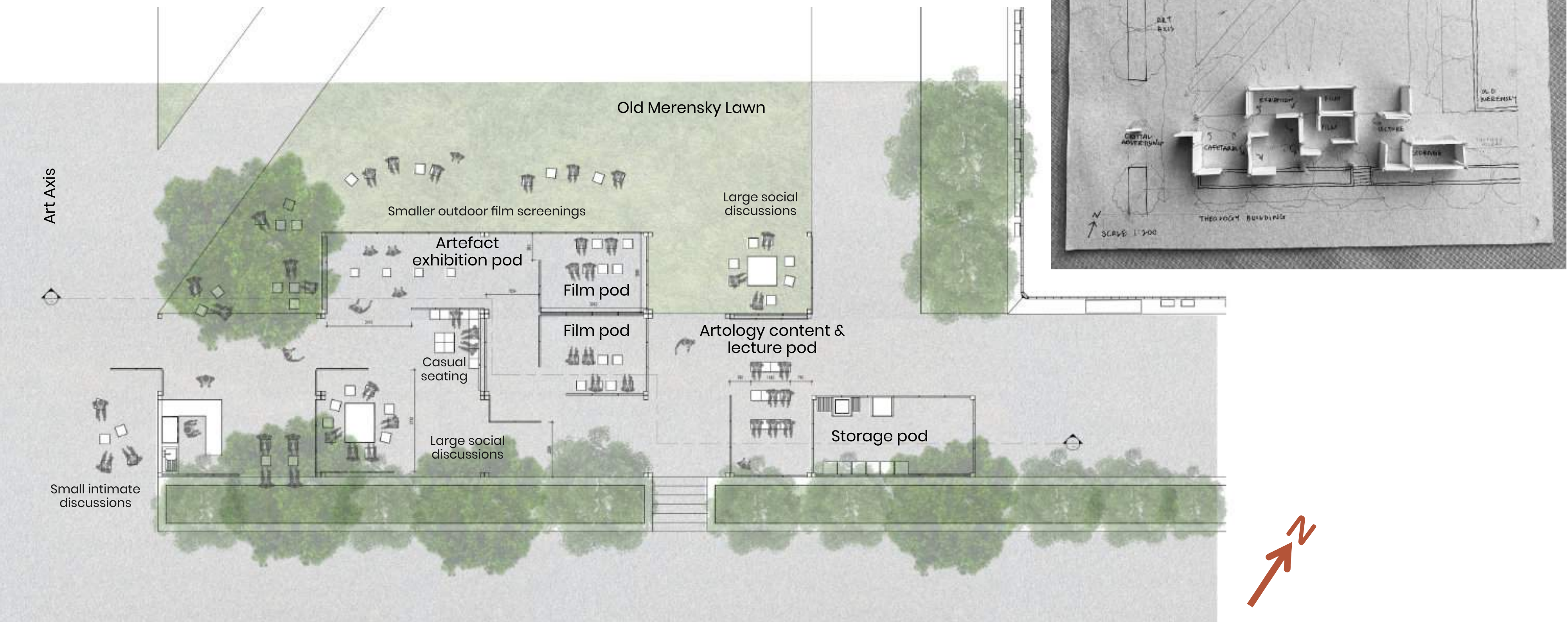
open exhibition space

During lunch hour - the exhibition space opens [12-2pm]



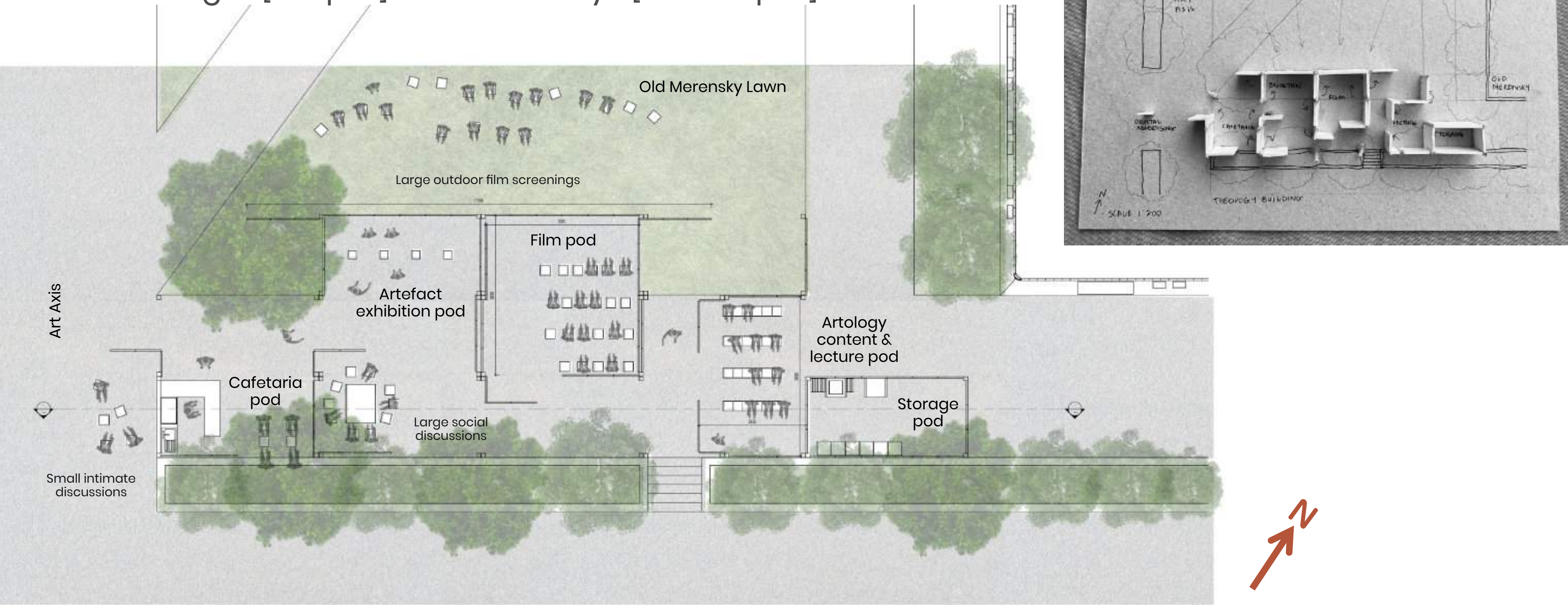
open pavilion

Main set-up during the day [7am-5pm]



open film screenings

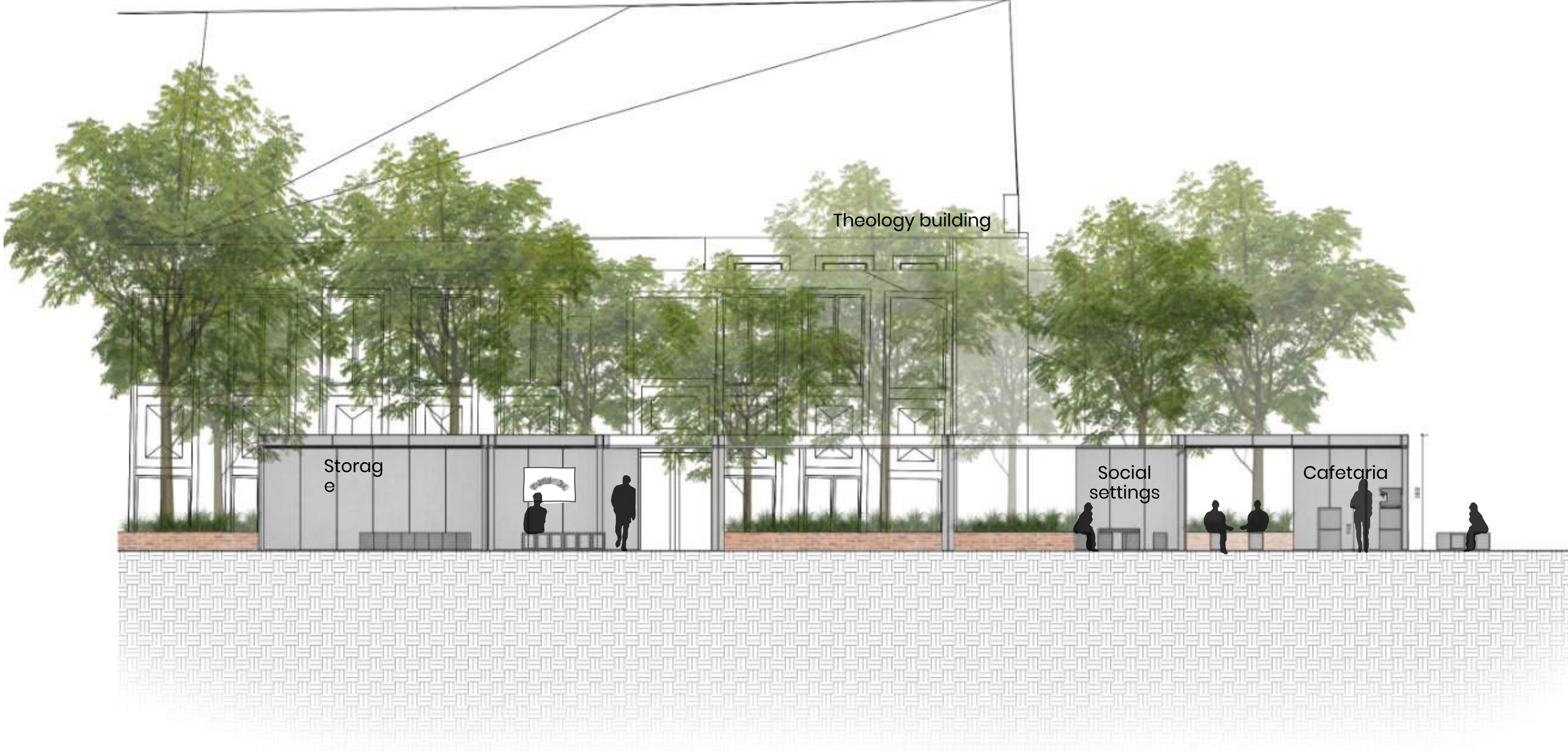
Wednesday lunch period [12-2pm]; Wednesday night [6-8pm] and Saturdays [8am-12pm]



Sections & Elevations



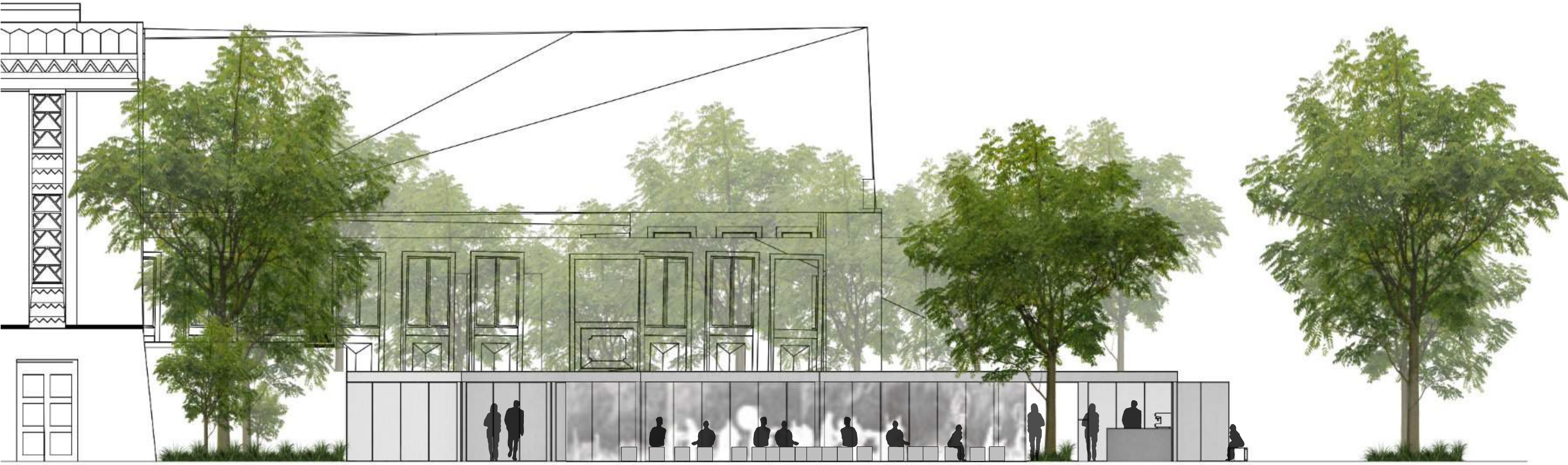
Exhibition & film pod interface
Section A-A
NTS



Cafe, lecture space & existing planter interface
Section B-B
NTS



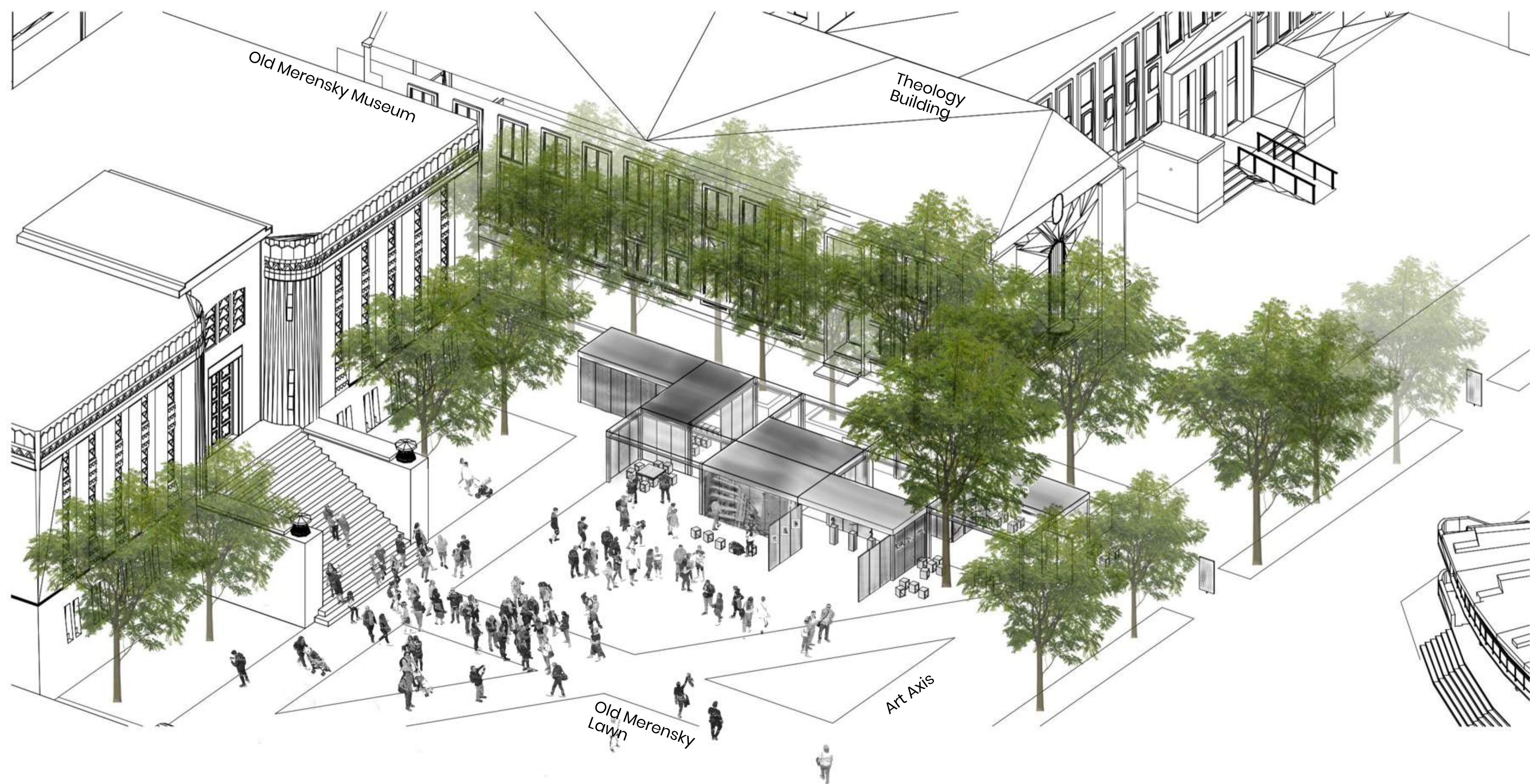
Entrance interface
Front Elevation
NTS



Exterior screening interface
Side Elevation
NTS

Implementation

open

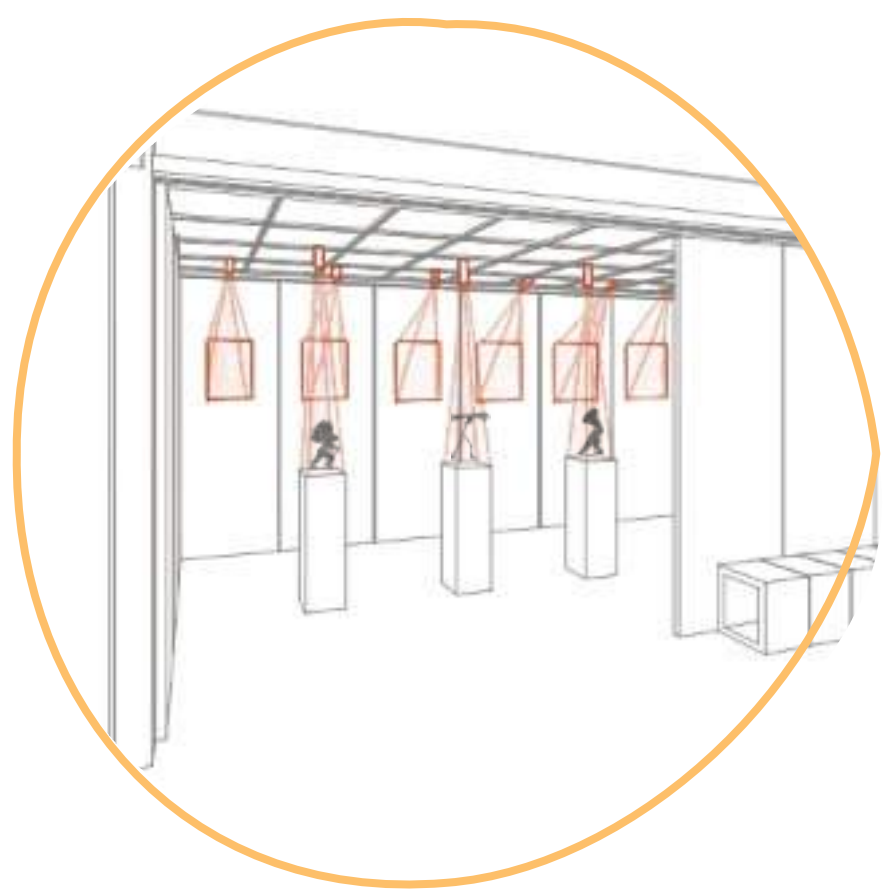


Daytime operations

Opens from 7am–5pm.

Digital screens

Recharged batteries plugged into screening device.



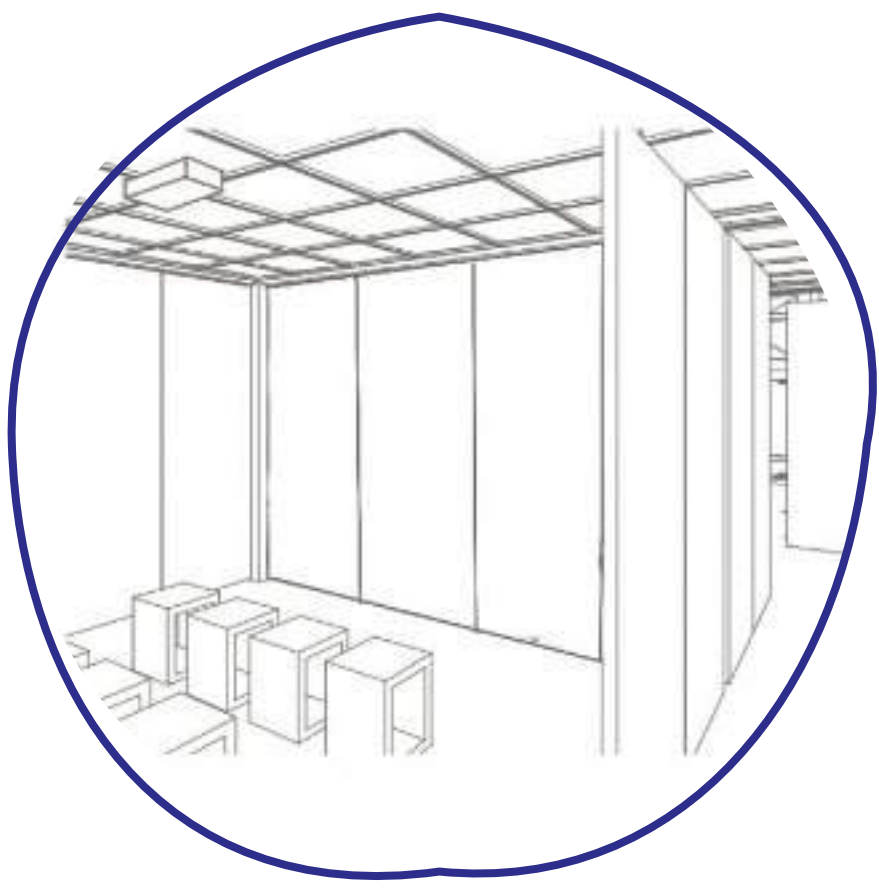
Projector and sound system

Projector and sound system switched on.



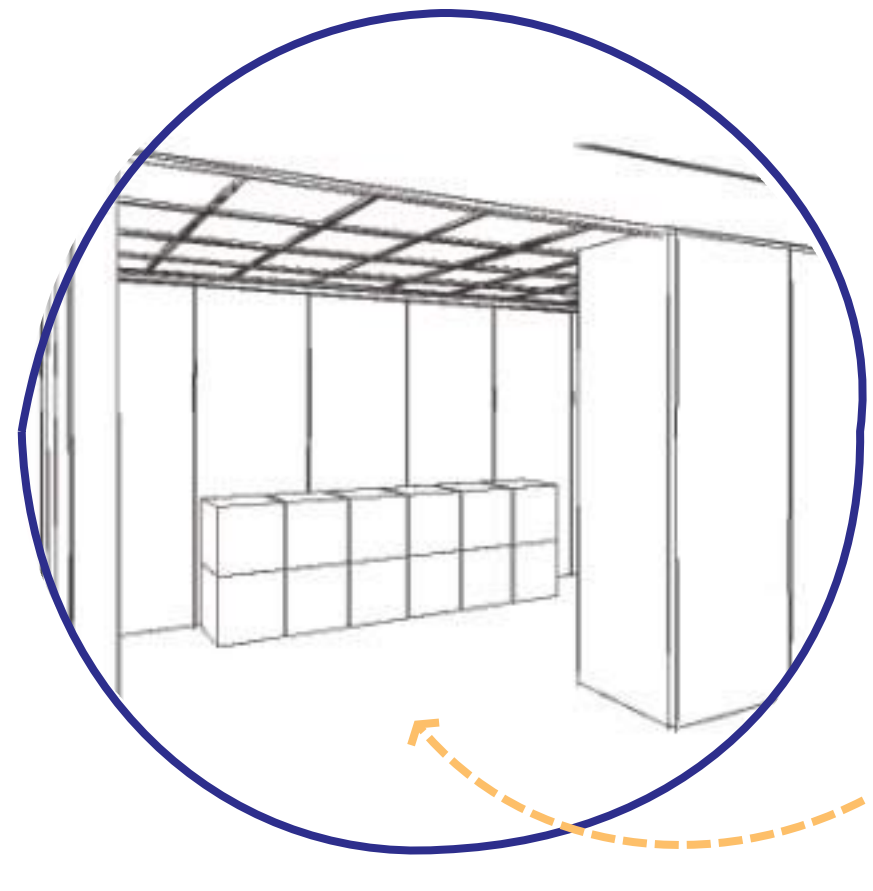
Art orator

Lunch period an art orator is brought in to discuss artwork. A question-and-answer series is held.



Track lights

Switched off.



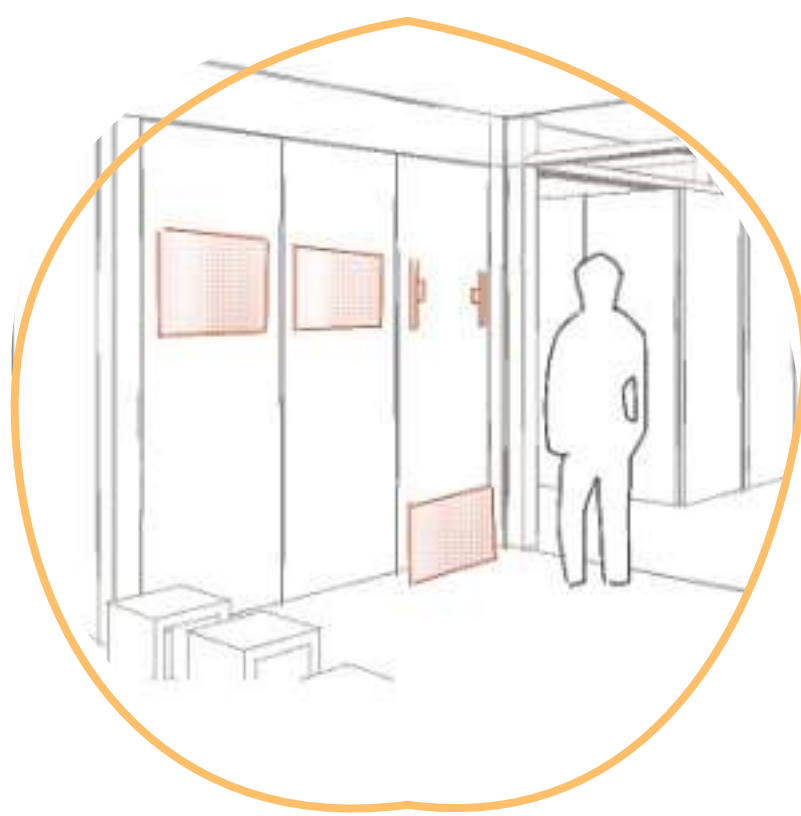
Panels

Panels are closed and locked up for the night.



Track lights

Track lights switched on and positioned correctly to illuminate artworks.



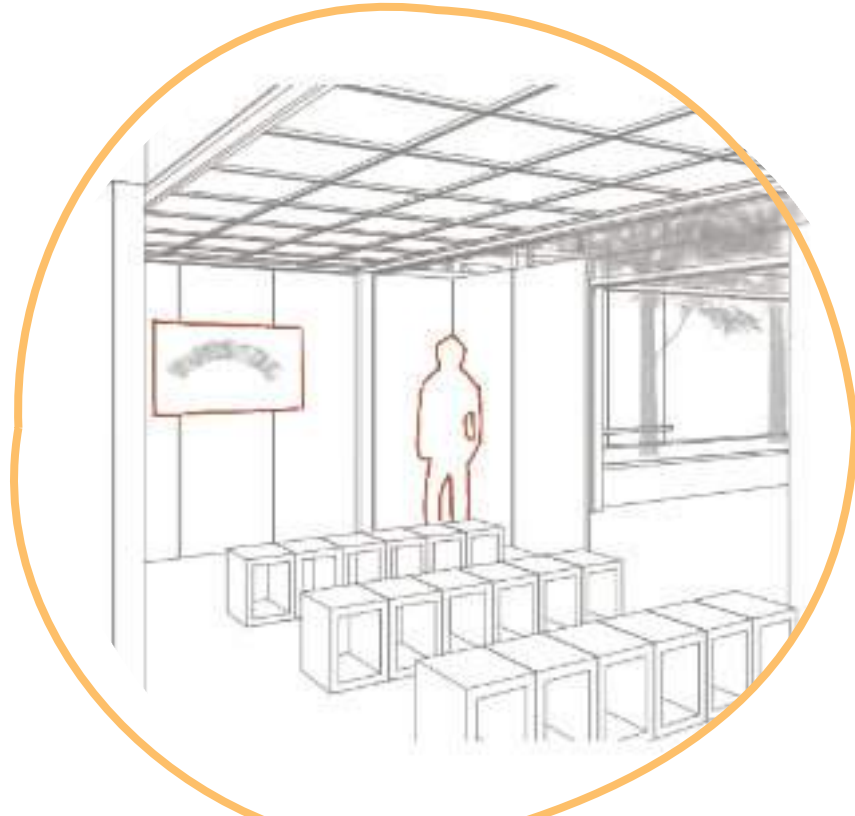
Cafeteria

Barista at coffee counter with fresh goods.



Projector and sound system

Switched off.



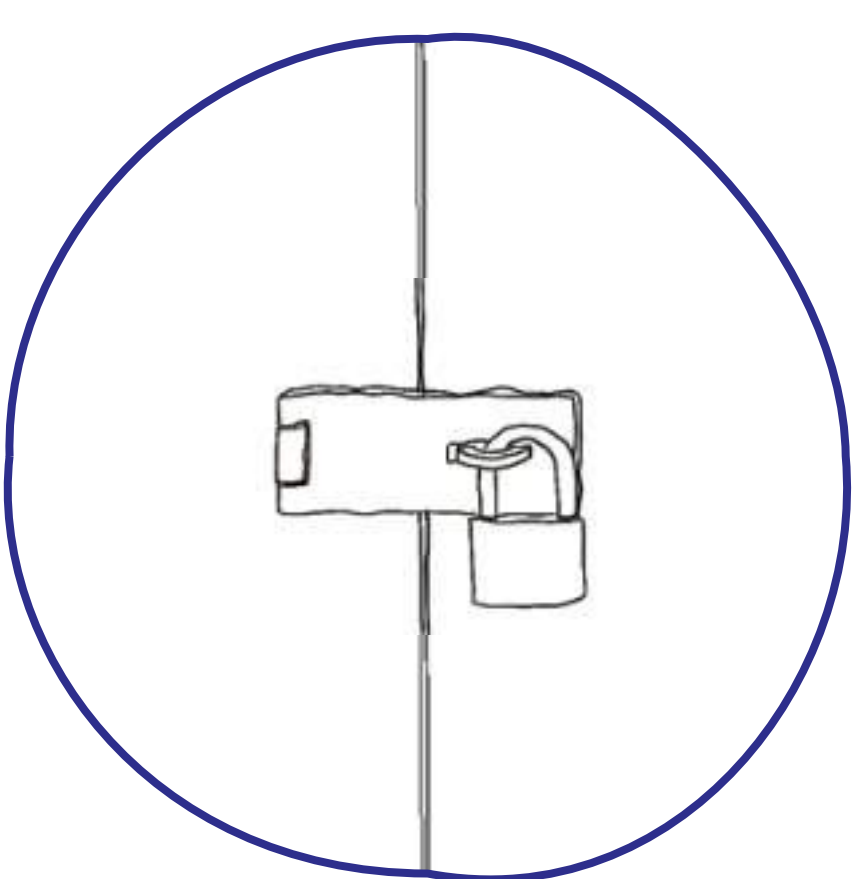
Furniture

Packed in storage.



Digital screens

Batteries removed and recharged overnight.

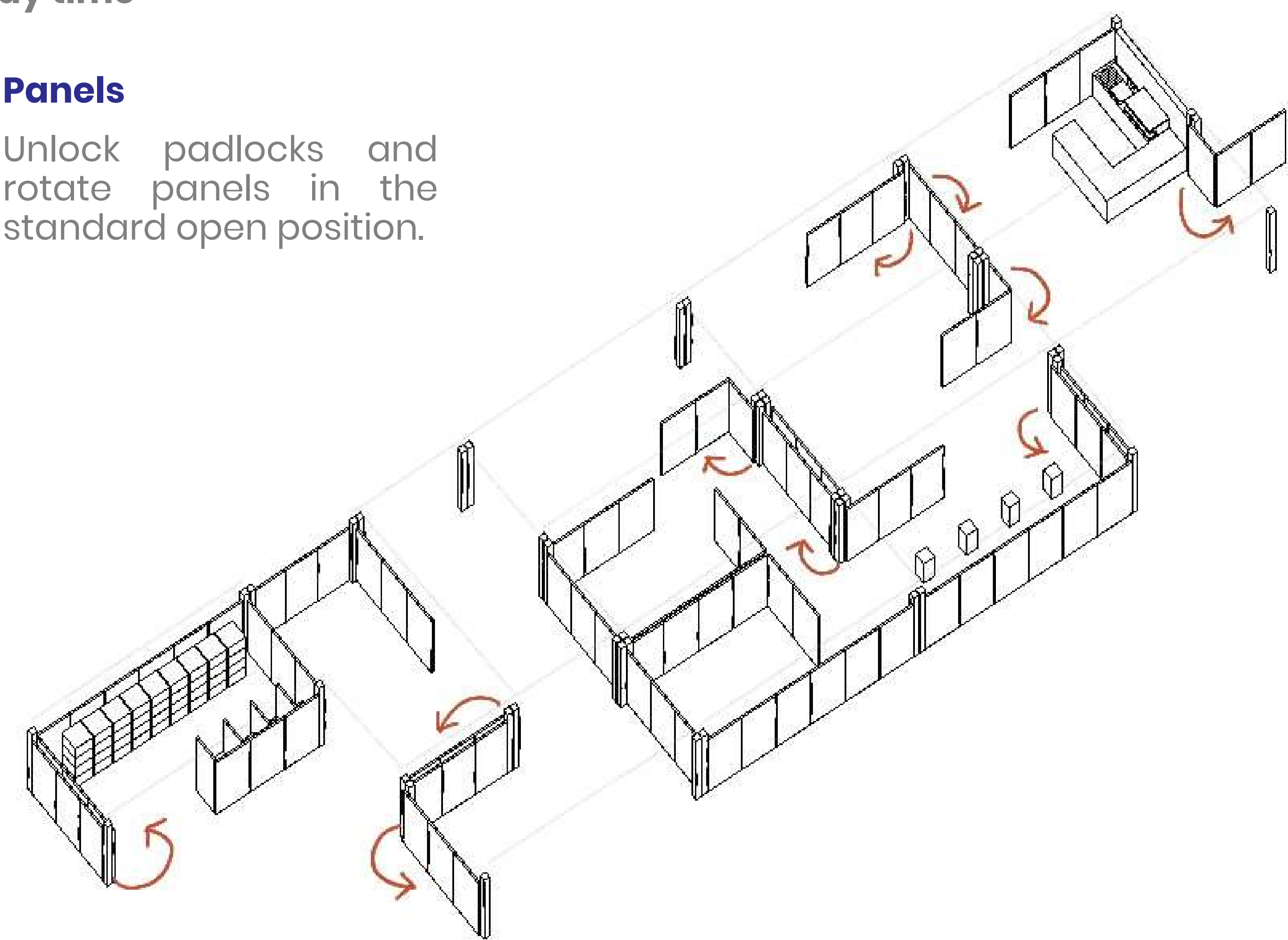


operability

Day time

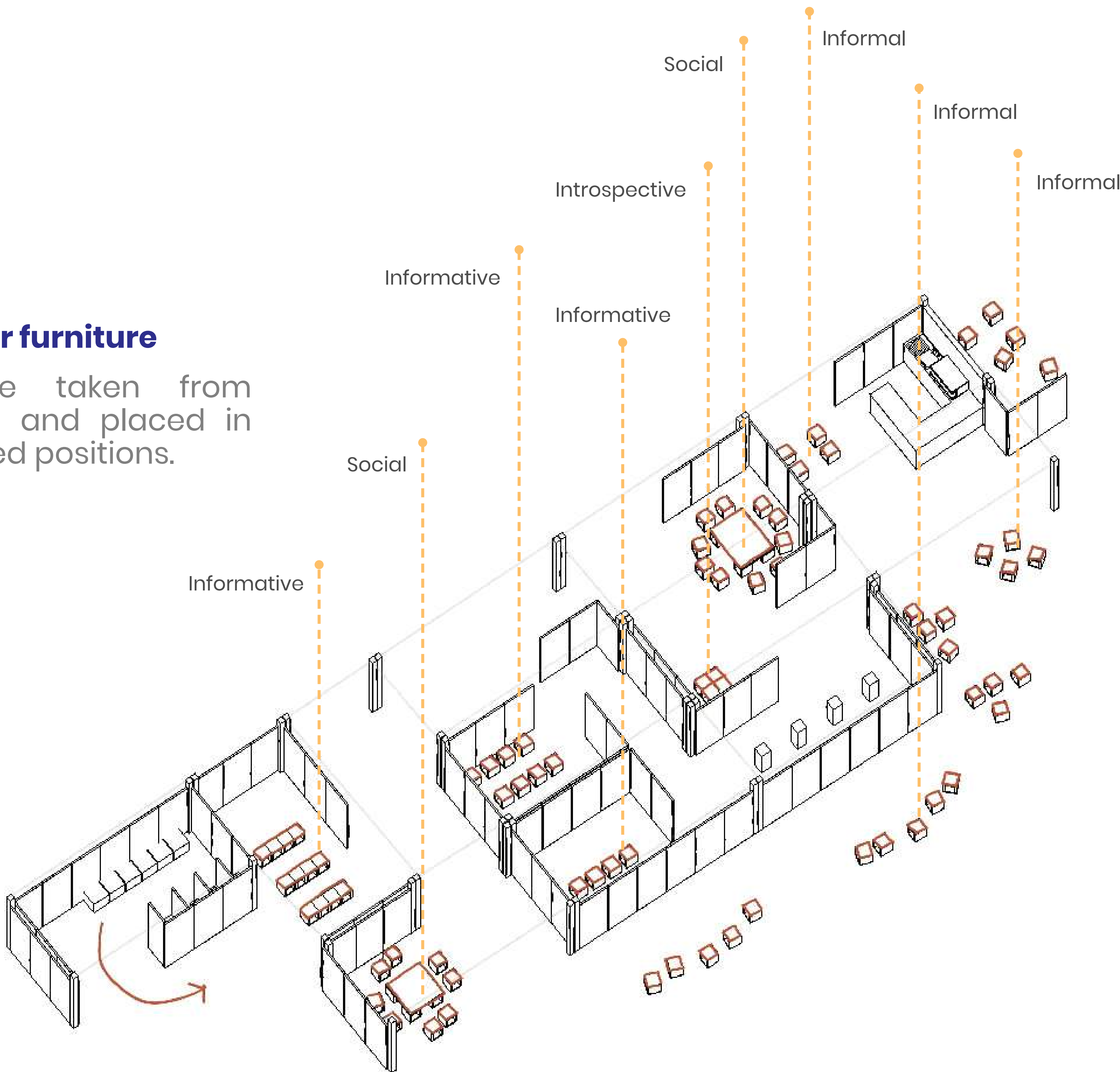
Panels

Unlock padlocks and rotate panels in the standard open position.



Modular furniture

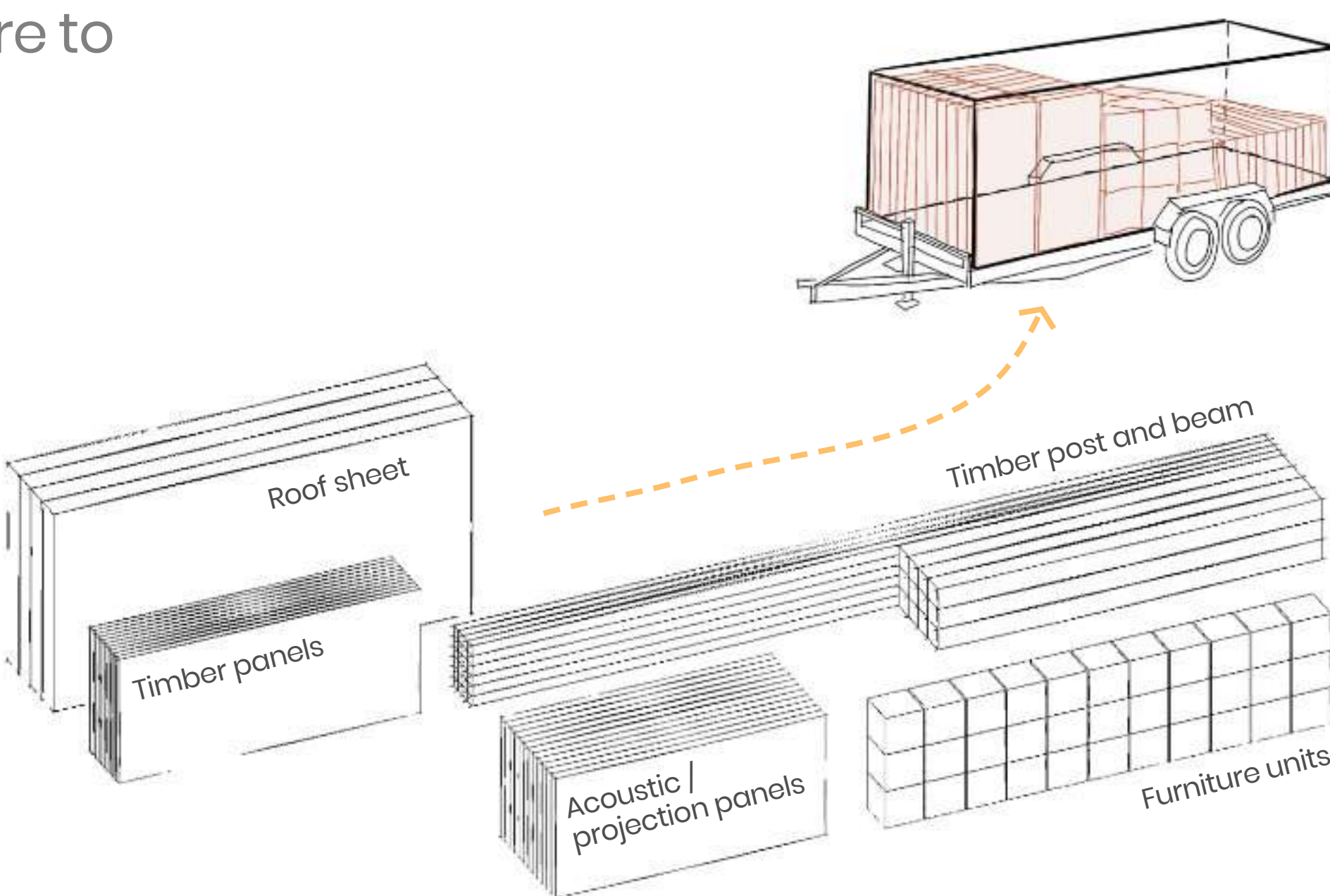
Furniture taken from storage and placed in allocated positions.



transport

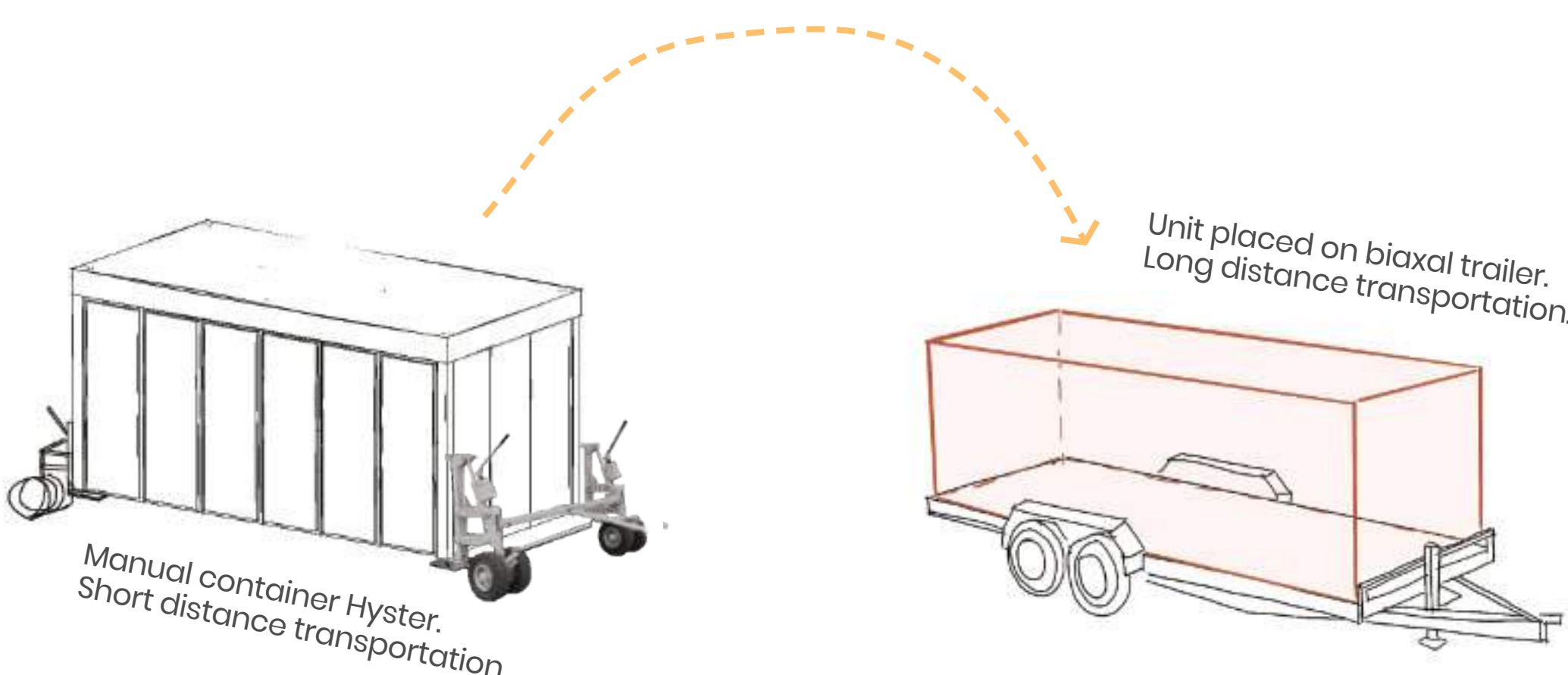
Components

Modular components are flat-packed and placed in container for transport. Components are to be assembled on-site.



Whole unit

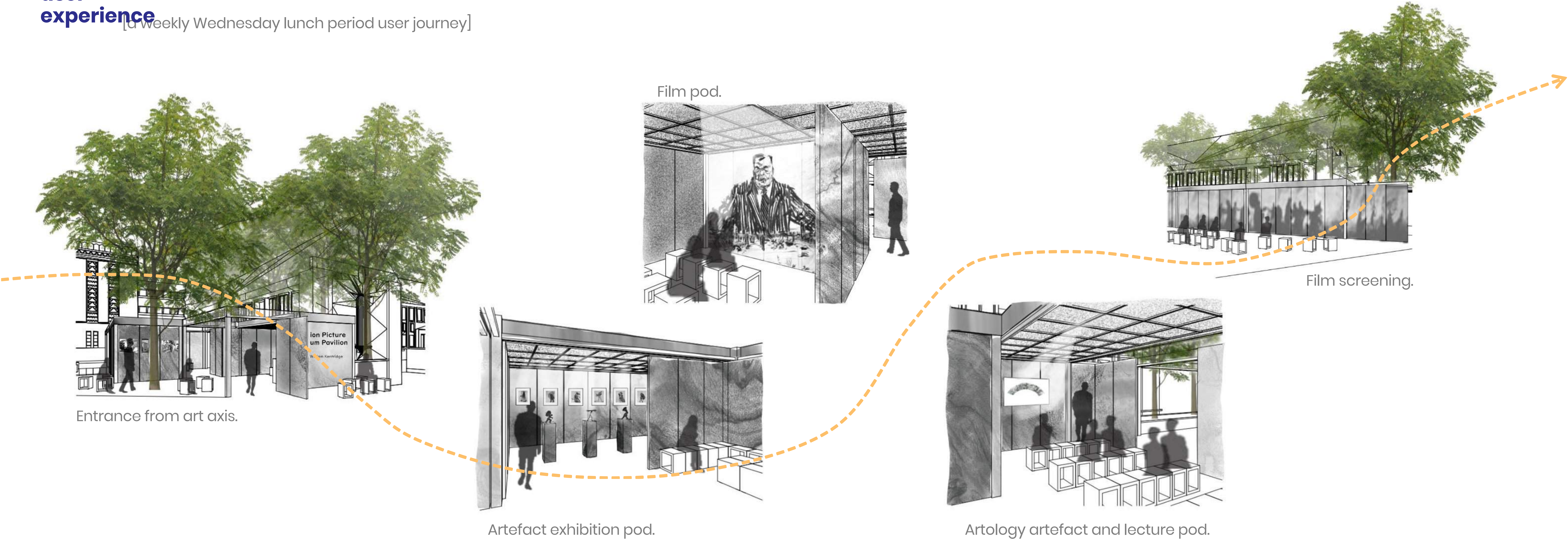
Shipping container dimensions [6x3x3m]. Can be loaded onto a biaxial trailer for transportation. Prefabricated for quick and easy placement on site.



Story Board

**user
experience**

[a weekly Wednesday lunch period user journey]



Reflection

challenges & opportunities

Designing a pop-up museum presented the challenge of creating a space that not only showcased William Kentridge's work but could also *adapt to host a variety of future exhibitions*. This required *balancing technical and functional considerations*, such as lighting, circulation, and spatial flexibility, with the *subjective experience* of how visitors engage with art. The process offered valuable opportunities to *explore curation* as an *art form in itself*, deepening my understanding of how the *artist's intent, audience perception, and spatial storytelling intersect*. It also encouraged innovative, adaptable design solutions and fostered *interdisciplinary collaboration*, ultimately enhancing my ability to create *dynamic, human-centred spaces that respond to diverse artistic and experiential needs*.

accomplishments

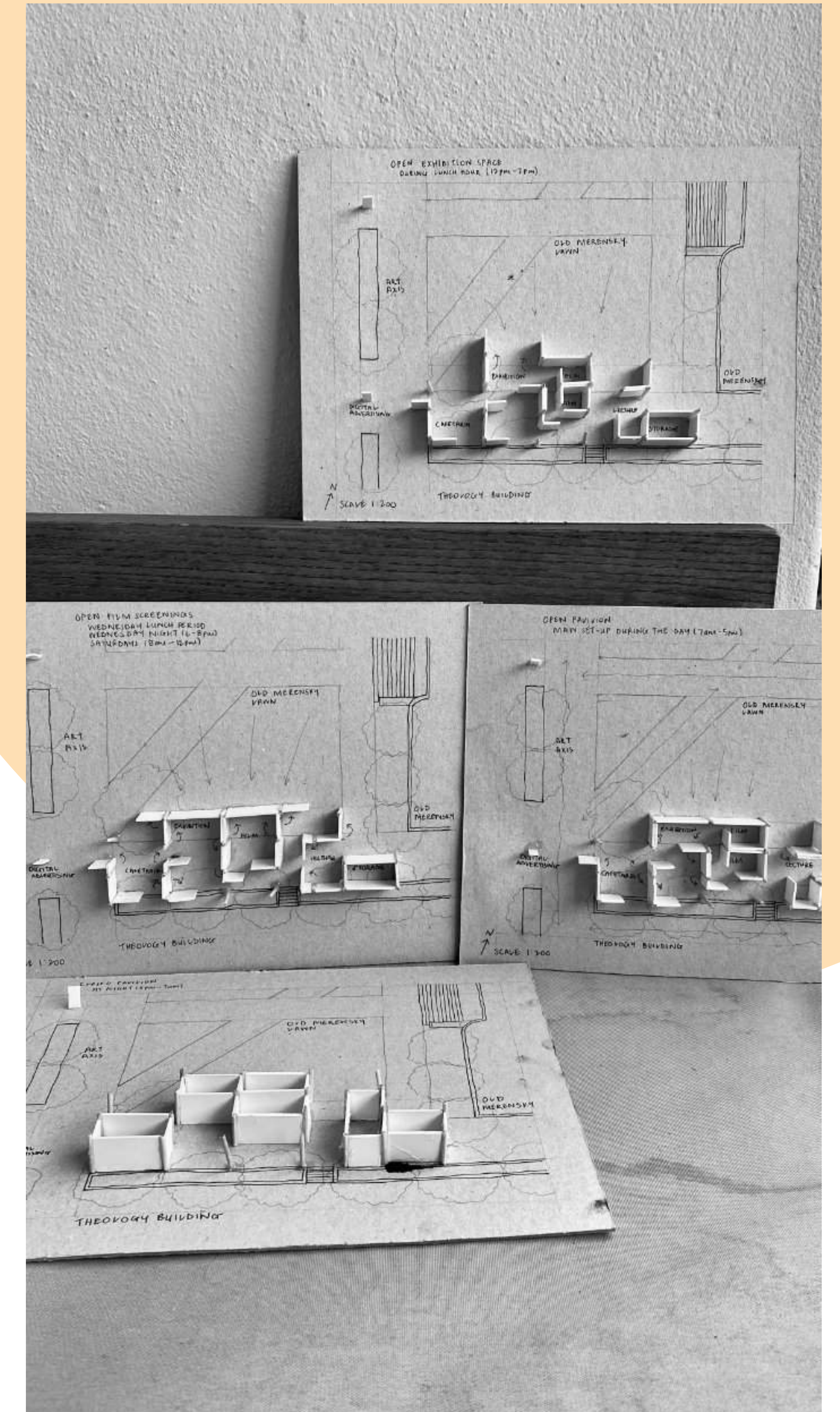
The project received a distinction.

personal growth & insights

This project allowed me to deepen my understanding of how architecture can shape and enhance user experiences, particularly through the *integration of digital media* and *interactive design*. I gained valuable insight into *balancing conceptual vision with practical considerations*, such as modular construction, acoustics, lighting, and operational logistics. *Collaborating with curators, artists, and technical specialists* strengthened my interdisciplinary communication and problem-solving skills. I also learned the importance of *designing for disassembly and creating spaces that evolve over time to remain relevant and engaging*. Overall, the project reinforced my belief in human-centred, adaptable design as a tool to connect people, art, and architecture in meaningful ways.



Going on a site visit with my classmates to Raw Studio to learn about CNC manufacturing.



Conceptual models for the final design.



The Heritage Studio Class of 2023.